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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, February 1, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Z2ZrQ_TurX0
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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[00:01:04] call the meeting of the Board of Education to order. Thanks everybody for being here. Most of you timely, we appreciate that a lot. All right, Dr. Mann.

[00:01:23] - Magic touch, for sure. Thank you, Mr. President. I move that pursuant to code, Virginia code 2.2-3711A40. The Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the purpose of the discussion and consideration of records relating to denial, suspension, revocation of teacher licenses and that jillian balo joan johnson kevin foster and angela schneider whose presence will aid the board in consideration of this matter participate in this closed meeting

[00:01:57] okay we have a motion is there a second thank you all those in favor say aye aye any opposed

[00:02:05] any abstentions all right we're going to move into executive session okay uh dr man it's a

[01:56:38] fingerprint issue thank you we convened today in close meeting pursuant to a recorded vote on the motion above in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.23712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge one only public business matters lawfully exempt from open meeting requirements under this chapter and two only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these

[01:57:14] requirements shall states state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken place the statement of departure will be recorded in the minutes yeah well certified by a roll call miss creasy hi miss halton hi dr siebert hi uh dr man Aye. Mr. Rutherham? Aye. Ms. Dutta? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. The Chair says aye. In case number one, the Chair will entertain a motion to issue a license in case one. I move. Thank you, Ms. Creasy.

[01:57:46] Is there a second? Thank you, Mr. Hanson. Again, by roll call, Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Rutherham? Aye. Ms. Dutta? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Chair votes aye. chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to daniel allen weiss is there a motion thank you mr hansen is there a second second thank you miss holton uh roll call miss creasy aye miss holton aye dr siebert aye dr mann aye mr rotherham aye miss dada aye hanson and chair votes aye and the chair will entertain a motion to revoke the

[01:58:25] license of darren lamar thornton so moved second Thank you. Ms. Creasy? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Dr. Mann? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. Ms. Dutta? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. And chair votes aye. I believe that is all the business for the board this morning. We will be in recess or I guess we adjourn to lunch. Was that publicly noticed? Where's Jeff? Yes. I think that was my understanding. Was this one publicly noticed? Yes. Okay. So we will adjourn to lunch and then we'll be back here I believe at 1.30.

[01:59:00] all right and we're upstairs we'll be upstairs yeah we live great thank you uh this is the

[03:29:57] work session for the hardest working board in the commonwealth the virginia board of education i'd like to welcome everybody to the meeting uh first up is the proposed revised 2022 history and social science standards of learning and i don't see anybody here on their way hello didn't mean to take you guys by surprise i thought somebody might have told you you're speaking today

[03:30:32] very good to see you very nice to see you too mr gecker board members superintendent baylow all right let's see you always do this all right thank you very much um we are bringing to you early the proposed revised 2023 history and social science standards of learning

[03:31:02] i have a few slides to go through with you standards of learning um you have authority through code for the standards of learning to be revised every seven years again nothing in this section of code construes that you can't do it earlier or more often but it is every seven years and the original standards of learning were adopted

[03:31:32] in 1995 and were reviewed again in 2001 2008 and 2015 and we are going through that process again our shared goal when it comes to our history and social science standards of learning we want standards that teach all of history and we want to be able to prepare students to be informed members of our democracy and our communities we want these standards to provide high levels

[03:32:09] or high goals for our students that they will learn the set of foundation definitely our standards the set of foundation for our curriculum frameworks which we'll get into a little bit later which are the in-depth guides for how teachers teach the content we want our standards to honor a diverse and robust set of voices figures and moments in history that's that good and the bad history and we want our standards to be representative of many voices and throughout this process of reviewing and revising the standards we've had 200 plus voices involved

[03:32:48] in all of the different documents that have been before you for review in november the board provided us with a directive for staff to basically use a november document or draft as a base document

and then incorporate elements from the 2015 and the august drafts that's what you have before you today that directive also was to clarify the errors and omissions from either 2015 or the

[03:33:22] august draft or even the november draft provide a crosswalk of the differences between the 2015 standards the august draft and the november draft and then lastly execute a transparent and timely process so our proposed document that we have for you today we hope that you have had a chance to look at it and hopefully like all drafts um we still have work to do but corrected errors

[03:34:01] and omissions um checked facts for accuracy and then also looked at um the traditional sequence of courses and what is appropriate for grade levels the proposed standards also when looking at teaching history and civics through not only fact-based, but also looking at those historical and contemporary figures, events, and eras, and also thinking about that inquiry process. The standards before you also have many opportunities for the application of facts

[03:34:39] and critical thinking. Lastly, the standards themselves, the civic strand, is very much aligned to the guiding principles that you'll find in the front matter of the document so let's talk a little bit about the process um we worked very closely um in working on the document that you have before you looking at what needed to be revised from the november document and the

[03:35:12] elements that we could bring in from the august 2022 document um looking at different discussion points looking at the editing that was necessary and then again incorporating your directive to us we had conversations with various groups many of those groups expressed and addressed their concerns during the november meeting mostly regarding corrections and omissions and then our team had the opportunity to provide instructional guidance when it came to the standards advocating

[03:35:52] for of course best-in-class standards regarding the accuracy timelines and content appropriateness so what we have for you and i believe you got this presentation a little bit in advance but we wanted to show you as um example of standards built out two different standards from 2015 then what it looked like in 2022 august 2022 document and then the november document and

[03:36:26] finally the january document so the first standard that we're going to look at um is vs.9 from 2015 and this is a standard in 2015 that looked at the civil rights movement and specifically we're looking at the contributions social and political events specifically to virginia and you'll see in the august 2022 document that same standard built out a little more we if you remember from

[03:37:03] the august document we had learning experiences that were attached to that particular standard next slide you'll see that standard and i apologize for the amount of content on the slide but um we moved to vs10 still looking at the civil rights movement but built out a little more looking at cases in particular in the first substandard and then what is proposed in the

[03:37:36] January 2023 document. Next. Yes, ma'am. Good afternoon. Good afternoon. Is there a word missing in the VS11B? It says. Well, which year? Proposed 2023. Okay. Investigate the effects of choices made during the civil rights, including but not limited to Maggie Walker, et cetera, et

[03:38:13] cetera. Those are people, not choices. And I think there was some language in an earlier version that made that make made the grammar of that sentence make more sense um it should um i believe have the word contributions voices and contributions or something like i'm looking back at what the anger would you mind looking specifically yeah yeah august 22 said the uh social political social or economic impacts and choices made by virginians including that not limited to yes

[03:38:46] this one says effects of choices anyway there there's a grammar fix that's needed in that one yes and i i'm sorry i didn't mean to slow you down but while we were on it i didn't want to miss it okay i'm not mistaken um i'll show also should read about their contributions of those particular

[03:39:19] um people i think the august language had it maybe the 2015 language had it accurate had contributions well the 2015 had impacts made by and august 22 had impacts and choices made by either of those can apply to people right whereas this one one word short i think it's one word short okay or it may be that language or it may be but maybe anyway you'll figure it out yes we have but what um what we wanted to show with this particular example is that the

[03:39:59] substandards include more content than we had in the 2015 document is specifically to the cases around um civil rights in virginia our next example has to do with the red scare and you notice from the document that you have we do have grade levels recommended for each of the courses

[03:40:30] and us1 which is general excuse me us2 which is generally a middle school course the red scare that information specifically in the standards was not in the standards in 2015 or august the august 2022 there was reference to the red scare and the curriculum frameworks for virginian u.s history and the learning experiences in the august 2022 document in virginia u.s in u.s history but

[03:41:03] this particular standard or the example that we are providing we're showing you that the red scare has been incorporated into the standards for us 2 which is 1865 to the present and in particular you see slight difference between november the november draft and the proposed 2023 where clarification and the standard has been focused more on that topic so let's talk a little

[03:41:43] bit about the curriculum frameworks just one of my favorites the curriculum frameworks um basically will provide more content and descriptors of the standards it gets the content will come from august combined with the standards document and we will also look back at the 2015 content from the curriculum frameworks this content will be incorporated into the work developed once the

[03:42:18] standards have been approved and the development of the curriculum framework of course because we have classroom teachers that are the boots on the ground they will be involved in this part of the process also so that brings us to the discussion about our timeline um with the proposed revised 2023 history and social science standards um hopefully they will be accepted for first review and we have um started to schedule the public hearings they will be held between

[03:42:57] march 13th and march 21st we have them at five six different locations across the commonwealth and we will get with jim to get the information to board members so that we can get that process rolling and figure out who's going to be where and then lastly final review we can do this final review we are anticipating for april 20th 2023 adoption of the history and social science

[03:43:31] standards of learning now there are many opportunities throughout the process as always for public comment or other input from whether it is different organizations educators and parents we still have to develop our curriculum frameworks there are opportunities while we are providing once standards have been approved and adopted and we have completed our curriculum frameworks we will need to provide professional development so we still have opportunities for organizations

[03:44:07] museum educators and so forth to provide input for us and then also school divisions are responsible for approving their local curriculum so the use of these organizations for local curriculum

adoption implementation and then lastly textbook adoption that is probably the shortest powerpoint i have ever done and i do appreciate your time and attention and at this time if you

[03:44:42] have any questions i'm ready to answer it's greasy um good afternoon good afternoon how are you all today um just wondering about the specific locations that you all have targeted as the public hearing locations just want to make sure that we're doing the best we can to to grab as many people as possible that want to you know as we've seen so many people want to contribute to this process are we giving them regionally enough of that opportunity as we go out so we have six

[03:45:19] we have eight regions um and we do have a hearing in far southwest coast to coast um we also have um moton so that's going to take care of our region eight um charlottesville mount vernon jamestown and roanoke so trying to make sure that yes to pull in large crowds but also make sure that we have covered as much of the state as possible i know generally it's kind of difficult when you're

[03:45:57] talking about region four because there's so many people in that area but um thinking about the dates the time of year mount vernon not only available but we felt like was a good place to kind of pull even south of Mount Vernon. Going west with Roanoke and then also in Abingdon so that we can still pull from the Roanoke area, but looking at Abingdon for far southwest.

[03:46:29] But yes, that was a big concern to make sure that we covered all of the regions, but also think about access. jamestown is the furthest high water or did i miss one we have with jamestown yeah i thought we also had chrysler no james south yes other questions yes ma'am just to follow up on that topic am i right that the goal normally is to have at least a couple of board members at each of these yes we'll

[03:47:04] all be welcome at any of them but the ideal is a little bit divide and conquer and then you all provide a summary some sort of what we hear from the public at those meetings what we will um have for you is a public hearing packet once we have the information as to who's going to go where and be responsible for that particular public hearing um you will have a packet that will have all of the information as to the different steps there will also be staff assigned for each of those

[03:47:38] hearings if not all of us at the same time but to make sure that we are able to pull it off and then we also have a member of the leadership team should be there also so at least one board member at least one member of the leadership team and then staff will be there but yes everyone is welcome to but we can get by with if we have to we can get by with just one board member yes and then there is some process for summarizing what's heard to share back with the rest of the board yes in the past christonia the department has hired outside basically a professional note

[03:48:15] taker i can't remember which standards it was they were but i was at a hearing in james city where we had hired somebody to go take notes not only there but throughout so that there was some consistency in the notes and in the summary you know is there any consideration i know this is not your job but is jillian is there any consideration given to sort of systematizing the way notes get taken so that the board can be adequately informed what public comment was in a consistent manner that may be the best um the best way we always take notes but if we can have someone to

[03:48:49] professionally do it and be at those hearings so that there is consistency um i just throw that out as a helpful suggestion to making this process actually work and again just to follow up on that topic if i'm correct the amount if we're going to consider that public comment at the march board meeting there's

a fairly short window in there so anything we can do to facilitate that summarizing i mean it's like days rather than weeks between the final i'm sorry miss

[03:49:24] holton final review we're expecting anticipating from april and not put on review and oh i'm sorry maybe i misunderstood all right the march board meeting is this item going to be on our agenda march of 23 does not refer to the march board meeting but rather the month of march okay if you're not anticipating that we will be um getting a report on that public coming at the march board okay thank you and and then just one last thing just knowing how these things have gone before on scheduling it can be difficult to make sure that we have at least one and preferably more board member at each of these meetings just juggling everybody's schedules if there's any

[03:50:03] chance we could have that schedule the the dates with us when we're together later tonight maybe we can i think you guys have already figured out the dates and places so helpful to have that soon or not later i'd actually asked to be uh consulted because i would like to make as many of these as humanly possible so there is some consistency across the board so if we could have them with us this evening then we could all get our calendars out that would be great for us to i'll send um the document to jim and kind of like a sign up list and you guys can get it back to us and that

[03:50:39] way we can put the board public hearing notebooks together to send those out to you we're still a little bit more than a month out but just so that you're familiar with the process and what happens at the public hearings and what each person will be responsible for doing you'll get that early and i just wanted to um also reiterate we originally had um chrysler they would be happy to host us but it was a conflict um but if you all want us to find something on the other side of the tunnel um we could definitely do that i'm a tidewater girl so i know all about the tunnel

[03:51:20] so we can we can definitely look into something um on the other side in norfolk or portsmouth chesapeake or virginia beach if you want an extra hearing that would be probably needing to come into the next week of march which is that's totally up to the board we are now in your process the documents before you we can go into public hearings and whatever you'd like to do we will

[03:51:53] gladly schedule all right it is certainly my goal to move this process through and so to the extent that there are board members who want to talk about revisions i would just assume before we put out a working draft that is labeled as the board's working draft i just as soon get those on the table today as wait till tomorrow i mean one of the purposes of putting it on the work agenda today was and first on the agenda was to have enough time uh to talk through what it is we consider

[03:52:29] suitable to go out as you know the board's draft for purposes of public comment i will say even though i label it the board's draft that's really more the legality of it i am not looking to line by line edit this thing today that will occur if it occurs after the public comment comes in and with consideration of the public comment. I take it that the current draft also took some into consideration, you know, what's been referred to as the alternative draft that the coordinators put in. I mean, it does look to me like the documents have begun to blend a little bit more closely.

[03:53:06] Let me ask you specifically, Chris John. Yes. Before you make a piece, if I can make one observation, next to the public hearings, lest anybody get what my grandmother used to call wild care and decide to show up at one of these we have three board members at one of those public hearings that's a meeting under the meeting of foia we can do subject to notice requirements so that may not be something

that's likely to happen but i just wanted to make sure that everybody's where that's we can manage that without having to go through the public thank you okay so i was

[03:53:40] about to pivot before my attorney interrupted me yeah rule this time i'm sorry you know to the extent board members have got comments that gee we just can't put this out at all let's get those on the table but specifically christonia you know we've heard talk about doing you know best in class which i still don't know what that means i know that in the last edition of the fordham rankings

[03:54:14] we were a b plus that there were five i guess jurisdictions that had you know extraordinary ratings in both civics and u.s history from fordham and you know and i understand fordham carry some political connotation with but really the rankings were based on clarity organization and things they were not specific content content in the way that you know we've had some discussions at the board about that so let's put that to rest do you believe that is currently drafted that both sets of standards the civics in the u.s history would get a pluses from fordham well being that

[03:54:51] these are your standards um and we've carried out that process i think we've whether it is this document or the alternate document does expand upon the 2015 civic strand and as far as an a plus the conversations that i've had with fordham members a lot of not making it over the top for that a had to do with not really the reviewers not really understanding our sequencing

[03:55:30] and um i think we've gone towards helping with that although there are concerns regarding specific grades for specific courses but that range of these are middle school courses these are elementary courses these are the high school courses um but i do think that the civic strand whether we're talking about this january 2023 document or the alternate document does build upon the civic strand and it gives us a really good base to work on the frameworks i do think that

[03:56:09] there are some obvious edits that we need to make and there are some instances where the sequence i've read some of the public comments and okay i can see where they're coming from with some of the criticism that they have but i think we're well on our way for that a looking at this document and take it into consideration what has been submitted as the ultimate document as i read it not really ever asked uh what do you think question mr kecker oh i'm sorry

[03:56:46] this is what's important to me i mean you guys are the experts and you know we're relying i'm relying on you i know grace has got the background in social studies that i don't have but i rely upon the department in grace to tell me what the real answers are um you know we scored well for them wise in content and rigor and i guess we lacked a little bit you know in clarity and organization those being the two sort of major categories do we think that we have fixed sort of the clarity and organization issues that they had and i know i mean fordham published a letter what last week explaining their involvement in the virginia process uh you know and i'm honestly you know, some of the points are well taken, right?

[03:57:27] Have we taken those to heart enough to, and again, I'm not talking about what we're teaching a different topic for now, but in terms of how we organize and, you know, in the earlier drafts, you know, I'd meet teachers and say, what do you think? And they'd say, they're not developmentally appropriate.

[03:57:42] We're asking kids to memorize things before they can read, for example, right? Do we think we fixed all those kinds of underlying issues, the big picture issues, without, again, getting into what facts we ought to be teaching and what emphasis we ought to place on different historical events i think that we

need to um there are some instances that still need clarity with um the civic strand in our elementary grades and can we highlight those again i don't want to hold

[03:58:20] up the document from going to public comment but i want to understand what areas in the document staff still believes that there is room for improvement so that when it comes back for real final review we can begin to make those changes but not just do it you know get it the day before and or the week before but actually begin to view public comment in light of what staff's actually thinking about it now or with that in mind i hope that makes sense it does all right so how soon do you think y'all can generate a document that explains to the layman meaning me you know what

[03:59:00] it is you think could still be improved that we ought to be looking to as we move into adoption of the product in you know may or whenever it's going to be april you're much more optimistic than i am so but we'll use your april as the final review today i appreciate that um i believe before we go out for public hearings so about two weeks to really give us an opportunity to

[03:59:34] dig into all the different um documents that have been submitted or as submissions we have some feedback from for example the citics commission right and um i think it's worth taking a look at what they've submitted to see how it um aligns with what we what we have here now so two weeks if we could and that way that gives you an opportunity two weeks before we go out for public hearings um if we need to print out something different or make those

[04:00:12] changes before we go to public hearings and do that no i think yeah my plan is to go to public hearing with the document assuming the board approves the document tomorrow and when i say approve that i don't want to be misquoted but i i mean a document that's acceptable enough how about that phraseology to be seen in public places okay so uh that's what i mean by approve just acceptable enough and that would be very helpful i think not only for me but for most of the board to understand where it is we're actually headed toward the end because you know we've had

[04:00:52] this tendency to want to edit edit edit before it hits the street and we needed to hit the street and then come back and edit edit edit so the work mr president you're asking christonia to do and get back to us on would be work that would fold into our final absolutely review absolutely but would not hold up the process of sending tomorrow's version on to public correct i mean as you know You know, Ms. Holton, we have to give, what, 30 days notice for public hearings.

[04:01:23] So right now, even if we approve something today, the quickest we could be out is March. You know, if we wait another month, then we're into April. It's a tough process to manage if we're going to look for perfection at this stage. It's easier to look for perfection at the end stage.

[04:01:40] Dr. Siebert, you had some comments? I was trying to stick at the macro level here. So in the spirit of trying to not have unmet expectations, it would help for me to kind of know with the end in mind, we've definitely had this bumpy journey, lots of pieces and lots of stuff.

[04:02:01] So what I want to know is what I'm asking is when we get to this, you have marks to do the work. We would at some point in here, we would get a true red line of the document that we probably accept first review tomorrow.

[04:02:21] Right. And what? So at that point, we have really good clarity. Again, we're still we're still working on talking about how we can provide information about the journey we've been on. We're talking red line against the 15 standards as opposed to. i'm just talking about what what we get done between first

review and final review absolutely so that i just want to when how far in advance of the april 20th meeting would we hopefully have that document the red line document the red line january document based on the feedback you get from these public comments well we also have to like you said take into

[04:02:56] consideration the comments from the public hearings and what we still have coming into different mailboxes okay um your generally your board book you get um like a week and a half before that meeting am i off on the about a week and a half before that meeting our goal would be within that board book we'd like to make sure that it's in there so that you're not coming to the meeting

[04:03:33] not prepared for what's in the document so we're shooting for considering we have public hearings that are going to go all the way up to the 17th maybe later and we're still getting because we're still in that public comment process we still have comments that are being submitted as we speak and we want to make sure that we read all and consider all and i don't want to rush us but i do want you to be able to get it in plenty of time so to make sure that it's in that week and a half out from your april 20th meeting and again i was meaning the public comment the hearings that you're going

[04:04:12] to have that's what i was actually getting at because of that reason we are still getting feedback on november document while we have january document that addresses at least some of those issues yes so yeah i just i'd like to as we talk about the calendar if we know when the red line of whatever we put forth tomorrow is available and hopefully when we get to april where everybody's speaking off of that sheet of music yes so that that's that piece for me um and maybe this is connected a question about the organizational piece and prior ratings it seems like we're getting a little more prescriptive in terms of what grade levels we teach what courses and so here is just

[04:04:51] my concern from the field for that having served in multiple divisions there are localities and divisions and school boards who have organized their total content you know their writing their reading and their history go together to the point where one division might have world geography as a four credit course for all eighth graders um and that's a fantastic opportunity for eighth graders to have a four credit course knowing that the code allows them to take off their transcript if they don't do well in it you know so having that flexibility and and that so ultimately we're not prescribing a given course to a given grade level i think is important so the word geography phase one. Some school divisions like to do civics in seventh grade. Some have found it fits

[04:05:28] better in eighth grade. So again, these are all well-reasoned decisions that localities have made based on their communities and the total package. And then lastly, there are divisions, for example, in the IB program where you might do your U.S. Virginia history in ninth grade and your government in 10th grade so that you have junior, senior year for IB history one and IB history two.

[04:05:48] So maybe we've been kind of prescriptive on the grade levels here because people thought we weren't being descriptive enough, but I just don't want to undo long-term local-built approaches to meaning and content, whatever the standards are supposed to be. So are these going to be prescribed by grade level, or these are just kind of suggestions? Dr. Siebert, we are now in the board process, so these are decisions that the board would, you all come to a consensus about making but on page 10 of this document and not just looking at the standards and the substandards

[04:06:27] but also the um the guiding principles on page 10 organization and prescribed order of history and social science courses historically virginia has offered flexibility so you might want to as a board decide if this is something that we need to think about rewording or looking at the staircase do we want to

give ranges for some of those courses because like you said some people will teach world geography to their eighth graders because they have a history and social

[04:07:04] science endorsed teacher who can teach that course or because of the responsibilities of teachers for science and social studies they may do social studies in fourth grade and science in fifth grade in the fifth grade social studies course may be a locally developed elective course about their tail or about their city so um i'm sorry say that part again they might have developed a local course for their fifth grade because they teach virginia studies in fourth grade that does

[04:07:36] occur in many of our school divisions so because we are this document yours that might be something that um offering suggestions for edits or rewording so that school divisions know that they still have that flexibility just maybe just a quick question how are the 2015 the flexibility or the cadence of things was that kind of built in in terms of how it was applied locally dr sievert it predates 2015 that's that's I just think we ought to try to keep with the

[04:08:13] same flexibility for the issues you raised as best we can so well but if I may the current language on page the chart says what's taught at each grade level with no equivocation there is language on page seven that currently says has have up it says historically virginia has offered flexibility around the grades in this configuration the draft

[04:08:50] standards are presented in the board of education's recommended grade level sequence school divisions are strongly encouraged to adopt this sequence is the current language so if we want to be and then the chart does not seem the chart doesn't say anything about flexibility so we may want to be a little more clear you know strongly recommended versus you know the reference to flexibility seems to reference historical flexibility rather than current flexibility and if we want to maintain the current flexibility that may well be a place where we want to look at the language and it may

[04:09:26] be one that would be wise to look at language now on rather than i mean i understand the the goal is to get something out of here tomorrow and i'm all for that and so we don't want to overly nitpick language now but if we go out with this version and you know salem i don't know but i'll pick on salem does fifth grade local history and this would keep them from doing that we may hear a lot of pushback when we go to rono that's unnecessary if we don't mean it to be as rigid

[04:09:57] as this implies so dr man but let's we can now talk about micro changes we'll move out of the macro if you want and the end of the micro because again i'd like to get into tomorrow with a draft that this board is going to say yeah we're going well and to that point i again i can't make this i don't have the magic touch with my mic so you just have to bear with me but to the point that was just being articulated i do wonder if one of the things we could decide to do is to um

[04:10:29] write the front matter of the January 2023 version and simply go with the other content. I mean, I know I had a lot of concerns about the tone and tenor of the content in the front matter, and I thought that the December document did a very thorough job of articulating a sort of a framework that both educators and parents could understand in terms of the purpose and approach. And I could understand people may not have the disposition to want to do that.

[04:11:07] But I do feel like it unnecessarily has a tone that feels more partisan than is needed in this kind of document. And I, with all due respect, absolutely believe in wanting to see our children aspire to greatness and see our country as great. There's no question I believe those things as

[04:11:41] an American. But I also feel like, you know, we have a responsibility with the choices that this work will make, given the journey we've been on, to, I think, try and restore a measure of public trust in our process. And I think we heard a lot of comments that, you know, it's water under the bridge now we cannot go back and contend with. There was a lot of public comment that I know in November, I couldn't from the dais wrap my mind around digging in, looking at what people were

[04:12:19] saying on public comment um but i feel like what i've read since that time would suggest that there was an overwhelming wish that we would have worked with august and not november as the base we can't go back and change that i'm not asking that we go back and change that but i think one of the ways we can demonstrate that there is a balanced approach to how we try and measure the power a public input that we could just choose to table a front matter and take the standards

[04:12:51] out as they are and try and get to a better place of content that really sort of speaks to not communicating messages we don't intend for them to communicate around expectations.

[04:13:10] If we are saying flexibility is important. So I mean that was certainly one thing I came here thinking a lot about. I really tried to edit, I tried to offer, I tried to figure out a way in the frame of the front matter to introduce a voice that I felt was really, as I said, I think, measured.

[04:13:31] And I couldn't. Mr. Hanson. I guess I might have read it a different way and when I am coming at this from the very beginning. It is going back and looking at where our SOL scores were at 80 in 2018, and we're at 66 today. And then we heard at our last meeting are the NAEP results of fourth and eighth grade reading and math. And I think we've had the largest drop of any state in the country.

[04:14:04] And so I'm doing this as more of a sense of a call to action, a call to help change things, because if we keep going on the trajectory we're going, it's not a good one. And I think we've really got to make sure that we've got the best standards going forward.

[04:14:21] And so I think the table setting to me is, again, the sense of urgency that we've got to focus on quality. We've got to focus on the reality of the decline that we've had as a state and obviously the decline that is occurring in all the different student groups that are more highly impacted um you know 19 drop in our you know black scores on the percentage passing

[04:14:56] of our social and history standards and you know 17 on economically disadvantaged and 16% drop with Hispanic students, so that's a frame of reference, maybe the lenses I was reading that on, and I think that to me, talking about some local flexibility to be in line with what's historically been out there is different than, I think, Amandina.

[04:15:23] Well, I appreciate your perspective, but actually when I look at the front matter of the document that was produced in December, I think it actually unpacks in a very thoughtful way the importance of the kinds of content and skills that we're actually wanting to see children have an opportunity to develop that is absent from this so if we're talking about content and really trying to help people understand the importance of content that is missing it is not evident there and i think that what was done to really talk very explicitly about the very things that you're

[04:16:02] articulating it's not there which is another reason why i feel like we might want to reconsider the front matter to ensure that that is represented i i have absolutely no problem with talking about the importance of high standards in fact i think it's quite easy to talk about those things i think getting to a

place where we can not only talk about them but make certain that all of the tools that are necessary everywhere to ensure that those high standards can be

[04:16:38] experienced by every single student across the commonwealth is equally important and i don't think i hear enough of balance to that even as we undertake this important work i'm not saying the standards as as they've been revised this is certainly an improvement over no over november i will absolutely say that no question so please don't um you know take my perspective to mean that i'm suggesting that i don't understand the gravity of what we face when we talk about how

[04:17:16] well children are doing what does front matter mean i'm talking about the preface i'm talking about the principles the guiding principles yeah i'm talking about the content that begins on page seven and flows all the way through the stair step that is what i mean when i say front matter and when you compare that information to the information that is actually included in the alternative draft it is actually more substantive substantive in its focus

[04:17:49] so uh miss miss um dr mann can i just clarify do you mean also the pages four to six that are the introduction principles and implementation section. Maybe we're all looking at different, I may be looking at a different draft. My draft, I mean, I hope I have all the pages. Well, I may have, I may be working with the wrong draft, but refer to the section. Is it, do you mean to be including the sections titled introduction, principles, implementation, and then background and context? Yes. Yes. I think when you read, when you read that content in this document and you compare it to December,

[04:18:27] There are some substantive differences. That's what I'm saying. December, you mean the November document? No. I'm sorry. I should say alternative. Excuse me. I mean the consortium. The consortium document. Excuse me. That's the problem. We do have a lot of documents. I'm sorry. So I've only been really looking at, I've glanced through the, I don't know, I'm not even going to refer, because there are several external documents. I'm looking at the Virginia Board of Education documents.

[04:19:01] and um i think i'm looking at it very differently than you are i think these the guiding principles which you know are laid out i think very concisely very straight they list out very um objectively and um so some of the things that you know students should know in history geographies geography civics from virginia history of virginia united states world civilizations

[04:19:35] And, you know, European history, some of it, and then the principles, I patriotic, I'm so glad that we finally have some degree of patriotism in here, clearly delineated, talking about the, you know, documents.

[04:19:53] I don't, you know, even now as I'm glancing through it, I don't see partisanship here. I don't see... I'll give you an example if you'd like, Soprana. Yeah. Restore excellence. That's a point of view.

[04:20:11] I think it's a fact. It's a fact. It's a fact. It's all side of this. I mean, excuse me, the standards themselves are not our problem, in my humble opinion.

[04:20:26] This is a revision of 2015. If we have issues with how students are performing on assessments, that deserves to be understood because that may not be due to the fact that our standards are lacking.

[04:20:42] That actually may also be associated with the fact that they may not have access to instruction that is qualified to teach the high standards. So I think when I talk about a commitment to excellence, I want to focus on the whole picture.

[04:20:59] It needs to start with the standards which drive the curriculum, which drive the assessment, which drive the accountability, which we hopefully will get to, which will drive where the funding goes. so it starts we can agree to have a different perspective i certainly am prepared to respect your perspective but there are uh there's terminology in here that does play to a perspective and a perspective is not necessarily fact when it comes to sort of what is happening for children and i just choose to have a different point of view and and honestly when i look at um

[04:21:39] the stain of slavery as an expression to describe what that experience constitutes, it's like a blotch that's sort of, let's just kind of wipe that off. I find that very disconcerting. If I may, if I may, I'm sorry. So again, it goes to, I think, threading the needle on a narrative out there that supposes that everything that's talked about through the lens

[04:22:18] of fact associated with race gets set we're teaching critical race theory and i've had to process all of that as i've had to read and i did take my time and i read through the january revision it is improved but it is difficult to constantly have to navigate these potent ways

[04:22:47] of dealing with elements of our history that it's so you may have a different point of view on how excellent our standards are than i do i feel like i'm entitled to have that perspective and i certainly respect where you are but as a board member if i have an opportunity to say what i'd like to see different i'd like for us to seriously reconsider what we have in the front matter and focusing on, granted, what came from the consortium is not a board product,

[04:23:26] but I look at what that diverse group of experts, individuals who are actually content experts in the subject matter that we're expected to bring our critical thinking to, I think it's worth considering. That's just my perspective. Yeah, I think there are as many opinions as there are people and um what when we came and when we started talking about these history standards last year what we were confronted with was a was an extremely defective product

[04:24:01] it was had with jargon heavy difficult to test academic concepts and you know making the sols so much more subjective and less specific and one of the things that i've i heard from so many people was laid out in themes and concepts and like i've said it before it yes everything was about you know looking at through looking at looking at things looking at life looking at history looking at experiences through a lens of race through a lens of uh you know enslavement servitude

[04:24:38] colonialism imperialism this uh you know drawing you know there was so little to feel proud about or to even look forward to or to even uh you know draw from it rather than traditional american values this was almost like activist civics activist history um so yeah i thought i thought that it was definitely through a lens of um lens of race um and uh this is you know exactly the kind

[04:25:12] of divisive and controversial indoctrination that parents are tired of they spoke up in 2021 against the activism and education by you know prior leadership parents do want to have a have a say in what's taught to their children um there was an election due to this leadership change in 2021 um parents are worn out between you know making a living working and then trying to keep tabs on what's being taught in classroom um the august standards was

[04:25:49] defective the board recognized it and we wanted these you know the staff to go back and revamp it and uh we had a big improvement i think the guiding principles uh laid out very simply very

plainly. And I do see it very differently from you having, you know, like I've said before, having grown up in a country with remnants of colonialism and a lot of socialism. I can tell

[04:26:27] you that this is fantastic to lay it out there and for something for our students to be proud of um and and to know that especially at this time when uh like like mr hansen said yeah standards lay the basis for our assessment so yes the standards should be very clear about what's being taught and um i i honestly i'm ready to move on with this draft and i i think it's fantastic i would not want this introduction the guiding principles to be removed modified

[04:27:06] Mr. President, I also have some serious concerns with the guiding principle, so I'd like to share my concerns, but also propose what may be a useful solution, which is I would suggest that the guiding principles page introduction section expectations and implementation, so page six through eight and a half, I do think is a political document, and I would propose that we delete that and then those who want to use that document as part of a press release or in some other way to

[04:27:43] promote our work on the drafts can feel free to do so but they are not fundamentally part of the standards and they're not essential to the standards and i i find them offensive and i think a number of other folks find them offensive in a number of particular so let's just get rid of the piece that's not necessary that possibly stirs up trouble i will say in terms of the very first line restore excellence i um suggest at mr mr president started off with referring to the fact that the fordham institute rated our 2015 standards a b plus which was almost the top right

[04:28:21] i mean there weren't a whole am i right miss brown there weren't a whole lot of anybody above a b plus in the Fordham ratings or five? Five above us. So we were 47, 45, I'm failing math here, 45 out of 50 were thereabouts. We were doing pretty well according to the Fordham Institute.

[04:28:42] Now I will say the Fordham Institute tends towards the conservative side of things and very focused on making sure we have patriotic history included and they rated our standards as well. I do want to defend the Fordham Institute briefly here while I'm thinking about it, because I do think there have been folks who've characterized them as extremists. And we have heard from some organizations that I would consider extremists, that is not the Fordham Institute. I've understood from the experts, including Ms. Brown, I think that the Fordham Institute, while they, you know, may have their lean, are very much a respected arbiter in this

[04:29:19] field. Am I right, Ms. Brown? So I think the fact that the Fordham Institute told us our 2015 standards were great, they just weren't the very top, is good news. And we shouldn't lose track of that. So to the extent that we need to restore anything, it has to do with performance, not the standards themselves. The 2015 standards were pretty good, and we're going to try to make them even better. But I don't call that restoring excellence. I do believe, Mr. Hanson, and maybe you can help educate me, but I believe the data you're referring to in the SOLs is pandemic-era

[04:29:55] data about the history standards. Then there's some national NAEP data, but no Virginia NAEP data on history that shows a decline. So, you know, yes, we had a dip in the first year of the pandemic, and I think I'm right that we went up a little in the second year of the pandemic.

[04:30:12] as you point out we had some subgroups doing worse than others none of that says our standards are flawed that says we got to work better on how we're teaching and that goes back to all the issues i hope we get to move on to about how we attract and retain great teachers to all of our schools so so

that's my first and i have heard from a number of folks in the field and one of the things i'm most you hear me most my soap my biggest soapbox is how are we going to attract and retain great teachers and we when we tell all the teachers across the commonwealth and all the curriculum educators across the comments that that we need to restore excellence because they've

[04:30:47] decimated it i think it's the wrong way to start that out this document um if i can just rattle through some of my other specific objections in the very next paragraph there's a reference to learning about great individuals of course we want to learn about great individuals but you know my brother is an american historian who focuses all on earth on ordinary citizens in the revolutionary period. We have a lot to learn from ordinary citizens, not just great the reference to President Reagan shining city on the hill. Well, you know, we could also reference

[04:31:20] the Gettysburg Address there or President Obama's Audacity of Hope speech or a Kennedy Berlin Wall speech. But to reference a city on a hill metaphor when it's really from John Winthrop, it's actually really biblical reference then used by John Winthrop. To me, it's a political statement to put Ronald Reagan's shining city upon a hill there. And then finally, actually I shouldn't say finally because I've got two more, the reference in the, you can't reference to an audience as

[04:31:57] inclusive as our Virginia is. You cannot reference the Declaration of Independence and Constitution as remarkable documents without also acknowledging that they contained fundamental flaws of enshrining slavery and limiting the protections that they provided for only to white-propertyed men. I'm not comfortable with that language. I'm not comfortable with the language of centralized government planning in the form of socialism or communist political systems is incompatible with democracy. I would concede on communism, but there are plenty of governments

[04:32:34] that call themselves socialist democratic governments. So is socialism compatible with democracy? That would be a great debate to have in a 12th grade government civics class. It would not be something I would want to take a stand on, that socialism is incompatible with democracy in this document here. There's language that I'm missing, and maybe it's in the implementation section. Oh, yeah. I think it's in the implementation section that's very troubling

[04:33:12] to many people. I won't go through all of my objections. They are in the draft that I shared with you. But there are two more that I feel the need to speak to. One says, we do not suggest that students should be exposed to facts, good or bad, but do not suggest that students are responsible for historical wrongs based on immutable characteristics such as race or ethnicity.

[04:33:40] I refer you to the Fordham Institute director's uncomfortableness with that language that they cited in their letter, open letter about our standards, I think it was last week. That language is code language. It has been used in many states to suggest that somebody has been trying to tell students that they are responsible for historic arms when nobody is trying to do that. Now you may think somebody's trying to do that. I don't think somebody's trying to do that, but we don't need to take a stand on that here. That makes this a political document. And I'm not arguing that we fix the language and we just get rid of it. And then you can use it in a press release if you want.

[04:34:20] The final one I will speak to, and I promise this time, at least for this section, I mean it when I say final, is the language that trying to say that teacher created curriculum is unnecessary. I had, my children had some phenomenal teachers who created curriculum. One I remember that helped the students follow a bill through the Virginia General Assembly in a middle school civics class. He had each

of them follow a bill that they cared about and they advocated for and they reported on to the class throughout. What great learning. It was teacher-created curriculum.

[04:34:58] I could give you half a dozen of those examples that just come to mind immediately from my own children's learning. And to me, the disrespect to teacher-created learning is a disrespect of teachers. And that is a really problematic piece of this document for me. So I would propose that we cut out pages seven, eight, and the top half of page nine. I think once we get into the background and content for the history, I'm sorry, now I'm trying to get on the right version, but I think it's the middle of page 9 that we go to the background and context section. That part I find

[04:35:38] actually not objectionable, and the only change I would make to it would be to add some language that the suggested sequence in the chart is to make it clear that that is, as Mr. Hansen said earlier a suggested sequence rather than a required sequence and i could i could live with that um so

[04:36:06] that that would be my proposed resolution of this piece of the standards so may i yes um just a few things the um i think great as an outstanding is is a good word even though however remarkable we We are all flawed in our own ways, but I think it's a great word to say any individual, to

[04:36:42] say just any, I think it's pretty charitable. As far as the Declaration and the Constitution, I think they're remarkable documents.

[04:37:00] I do not believe the Declaration and Constitution enshrined slavery, nor did they limit protections to white-property men. Maybe you meant to describe the Constitution, but it didn't mention race or slavery. Ms. Duda, it did. The three-fifths clause. It didn't mention race or slavery, and I understand it's hideous for a person to be considered on anything other than one whole.

[04:37:40] it's unimaginable and it's abominable but and from what i've read i've tried to do the research and i understand there is nobody defending it nobody defending it it's just a fact that it was a compromise of whatever if you read about it to limit the congressional representation of the southern states constitution did not end slavery but you know it uh never would have been ratified

[04:38:13] i guess if it if it had as far as the uh socialism or communist i think socialism is just about as bad as as communism socialism is like the nanny state which predominates in so many parts of the world it's it co-ops the important decisions belonging to families and individuals i i come from a country which used to be more socialistic now than you know then than it is now but it's

[04:38:45] it is it creates dearth dependency and depression um it may be some people may use it as a euphemism but you know it produces a quality too dumb to govern itself and really roles best served by government are comparably through few and um and considered by many quite debatable um i've never heard Boredom Institute as being described as conservative. Some, by many, it's been described

[04:39:20] as moderate. I don't know what's conservative about this. There are many things about it that I don't think I would like or like. I think when you create a curriculum that is too vague and open-ended, that's the problem. You know, it's a document of standards with an absolute requirement that any you know curriculum provides a level of consistency and comprehension so teachers and students can understand it and whether it's teacher created teacher led

[04:39:55] a level you know they obviously there is much room for the curriculum and good teachers to be able to creatively inspire curiosity inquiry etc so I am not sure what the in my mind like I said there are

just as many views and viewpoints and opinions as there are people what one might

[04:40:26] find partisan another may not what one might find um impolite another might find um patriotic so i i think that i understand this is up for first review and um i very strongly feel that the principles. It's a great introduction to the standards, and it should remain how it is.

[04:40:59] If you want to wordsmith some things here and there, maybe we can talk about it. But I think it's great. So I'm going to take this in a different direction, because I sort of, I mean, my my purpose here is for us to have a document us to have standards that work in a classroom

[04:41:35] that are executed well meaningfully and that our students come out not just with a bunch of content knowledge in their head right but they can absolutely synthesize and communicate what they learned what they understand and so um i guess for me as i look at at a lot of this um the restoring excellence i completely get the the offense to that but i also think about too that um we have

[04:42:13] and and alan's gonna probably look at me a little funny for saying this but we have given local school divisions so much flexibility in their ability to pick and choose their sequencing and their opportunities for what courses they are going to teach, particularly in our middle and high school levels, that many school divisions have abandoned, this is my soapbox, teaching civics.

[04:42:42] And while I certainly appreciate teaching strands, I think it's awesome, but many school divisions are allowing kids to, of course, take higher level courses that help in middle school to promote their transcripts from a high school perspective. And some kids just are not taking civics. And I think that is a very important piece of getting them through high school and getting them to U.S. history where they have to pass the course to graduate, but don't ever get assessed

[04:43:19] from a state level on that that course content anymore so that is where I am on this I absolutely feel that some of these courses whether you teach it in sixth seventh or eighth grade is of no consequence to me but that it is taught that these courses are taught in in our schools and every kid has to take six you know civics and they have to take U.S. History 1 and U.S. History 2 those are things that i think we have absolutely have to commit to um i don't care about the grade level

[04:43:57] as much as i care about the fact that they have to get that content um yeah i i thank you for bringing full circle on where it's taught because i i don't know of any divisions where civics isn't uh it isn't really central to the middle school curriculum but it is sometimes eighth grade sometimes seventh grade and those kinds of things um thank you i i also wanted to most of my effort and review preparation has been on the teacher side of things and the school implementation side of things so so i'm wrapping my mind around the prior conversation i appreciate the candor and

[04:44:37] the perspectives being shared um so before i get to some macro level content type things just structural often for example we we had to orient ourselves here at the beginning what part of the document were we talking about and so i think we need to anticipate that being something we need to help the public do as we move forward what part of the document are they talking about when i look at the 2015 standards online i see the standards broken out by grade level but i don't see any front matter preface or anything online from 2015. so that's where most of my work looking at our current document in 2015 has been on the standards themselves and not so much uh in in the

[04:45:17] preface the front matter um very not a lot but a limited experience working with doctoral students and the typical five chapter dissertation it is often helpful to know which chapter we're working

on when we're working on it and so are we working on your methodology are we working a literature review or work on your findings we look at what are your recommendations so um it may be in in terms of helping those of us who are school folks focusing on the the standards to you know what we what gets deleted or not i don't know maybe just get you just becomes two documents here's the preface stuff and here's the standard stuff um i i just throw that out there as a potential so that

[04:45:56] way as people speak to it whether it be in their written review or at their public comment hearings or whatever else we know what they're talking about what which part of the document are they working on so i i have some thoughts on the standards piece that i will wait because i don't want to end any discussions being held on the uh the front matter part mr president may i ask christina to help me because i i i endorse miss creasy's point that civics and economics ought to be taught to every student in the commonwealth can you clarify what what are the current requirements

[04:46:34] both as to what's taught and as to what's tested and that's in particularly i think we all understand the k through four well we understand the k through three sequence i don't think there's any dispute about that and we all understand that u.s history is taught either in fourth we're in fifth grade there may be some flexibility around that i think the the biggest question is middle school civics and economics is taught is it required is it required to be taught civics and

[04:47:08] economics what will many times happen in school divisions if there is a high school course offered to eighth graders civics and economics as many times move down to seventh grade and they have adjusted their sequence to where us one may be in fifth grade and then us two in sixth grade c e in seventh grade and then offering that credit bearing course to eighth graders and many times it's world geography so there may be some it may get moved around when but right your understanding

[04:47:43] is that a hundred percent of virginia school children are required by their local school divisions to take the history and the civics and economics course and it's a testing civics and econ is tested but i am not going to be able to step out on a limb and say 100 percent um but it is our middle school course it is where we have the civics and economics strand and there is an sol test for it and maybe shelly can help me a little bit all those who are required all those who take it are assessed on it. But the question is, do local division, and we think that all, I think I

[04:48:22] heard you saying, you think all the local divisions are offering it. The majority. I cannot speak to a division that does not offer Civics and Econ, because we've always had to teach that course in our sequence. But many, the majority of the school division, of our school divisions, offer C&E at eighth grade. If they want to offer a credit bearing course, then they'll move that sequence down so that civics and econ, because they still have an SOL test attached to it, civics and econ

[04:48:56] will move down to a lower grade. Can we get some clarity before tomorrow? Is there a state requirement that the divisions offer civics and economics? And also, let's ask the same with respect to US 1 and 2. Okay. Because I know where to look for what we require at high school.

[04:49:14] I really think the variable one is the world geography, which is sometimes offered at high school instead of eighth grade and may, some students may take world geography and some may take world one and two rather than world geography, or some may manage to get them all in.

[04:49:29] but i think that the civics and i think it was certainly always my understanding that it was our intent that everybody get us one us two and civics and economics at some point so if that's not already um

clear in our requirements maybe you all can help us figure out how to clarify that okay i do notice that your sequence here has world doesn't has civics and omics in seventh grade and i'm hearing you say that most folks offered at eighth grade so i wonder if there was a rationale for moving that? Is there a reason why you all put it in at seventh grade rather

[04:50:06] than eighth grade? Rationale in looking at Virginia studies and then the next course to be offered is US 1. So that would move the sequence of courses down, whereas with the flexibility that local school divisions have, they use that upper elementary to either develop a course, or wholly teach history and social science, Virginia studies in fourth grade, and then science in fifth grade because of the teacher's load. So you have that. That's where a lot of the flexibility and sequencing would really come. Now, as far as a credit

[04:50:44] bearing course being offered in the middle school, the first thing that we have to, for a school division to look at is whether or not they have teachers who are endorsed to teach those courses so that's something that will also have to be looked at if you could come back to us with some language for tomorrow that makes it i don't mean to speak for beyond this corner of i would like to see language that makes it clear that the divisions are required to give

[04:51:20] offer and require each student to take us one two and civics and economics but but that maintains their flexibility as to when those are offered in the sequence if you could give us some language that we can do that i would be grateful and remember offering is different than required yeah right so we want them to offer and require all students to take those three courses before we have christine to come back language let me get some consensus from the board if that's okay i'll need a formal vote but is there a consensus around uh the change that ms holton is proposing

[04:51:55] so that we can have it on the table tomorrow or not could you restate the change as i understand what miss holton is saying other than to miss creasy right now what i understand miss holton is saying is she wants civics and economics to be required to be taught to not only offered but actually taken by every student in the commonwealth i want it to be just like the k-3 and the fourth grade sequence, but without specifying when, you want everybody to have to have it as opposed to

[04:52:34] have to have it offered. And I do think that the vast majority, that is the practice, but Ms. Creasy is telling me that there are some that are with the advanced students, basically trying to get a high school course to some of the advanced students in eighth grade are pushing out civics and economics rather than pushing it down pushing it out that's not in all cases though this is not at all just there are some that are doing that and and we don't we don't want to what i'm offering would not would take away that flexibility but otherwise maintain

[04:53:10] the flexibility we've talked about i think it's a great idea i mean growing up i had a different teacher and in every grade i had civics history geography but um if if you've got 180 days in a year school year uh you know if you're going to put in something you're going to have to take something out i assume or you're going to have to abbreviate the matter so i mean i think it's it's a great idea to to have geography and civics the question is how to manage it it was economics

[04:53:43] and civics it's civics and economics is there any local control issue here i mean i'm not against this in principle but like i'm curious just how big is the problem we're trying to solve you know i don't know how rampant this is again i'm not knowledgeable with the entire commonwealth so that's my first kind of consideration is how big is the is the problem clarity there would be good but i also don't want to

create unintended so again i can't speak as much to that piece but for example i know that there are people uh teachers who are endorsed in world can teach world geography and earth science and having that teacher in the ninth grade or the eighth grade who can teach world geography and earth science the locality might merge make have a new name in there and they're

[04:54:21] working on content in both because again the peoples are different but the physical geology the physical geography related to the geology there's some really good connections there so i just wouldn't want to take away the opportunity for a locality to integrate courses in really meaningful compelling ways um but not being said absolutely civics and economics is is in all my experiences a cornerstone of the middle school experience i think we even added a statutory requirement the legislature added a statutory requirement not that long ago for a middle school part of a course that was the career career course right and that maybe sometimes gets

[04:55:01] fit into i don't know never mind i'm just distracting us sorry let me make sure i'm clear mr gecker on what i don't really know what what happened to my idea of consensus around this The first thing I have is going off of what Mrs. Houlton said to find out if we have language, whether it's in code or regulation, as to whether or not civics and economics is required.

[04:55:38] Yes. And I know that you take the course, you take the test. So what we're looking for is the requirement of civics and economics for middle school. That's the first.

[04:55:54] And then going off of what Dr. Sieber said, how much of this is a problem. so really looking at schools or school divisions that are not offering civics and economics in middle school to where students are not taking not requiring not requiring civics and economics in middle school it's is that did i summarize that correct excuse me for what i said we're

[04:56:26] offering okay requiring as opposed to offering okay and then we want do we want the same question answered with respect to us one and two or is that different it's different because now you often have people go to fifth grade yeah right well but us one and two we want to know are they currently required to be taught somewhere test covers both so that is a testing subject as well civics and economics gets tested and i think the only standardized test now is the fourth grade

[04:57:03] Virginia studies and economics and the end of course. Could a local division say, I keep picking on Salem, just decide we're going to skip US 1. I know, that's why I can pick on Salem. Can we just skip US 1 and 2? We're not going to offer it or we're going to offer it, but we're going to let it be an elective. The closest off the top of my head, the closest I can come to it is written in code that all local school boards are required to provide a program

[04:57:38] of study for a k-12 program of study and each of those are listed u.s history civics economics personal finance all the others but the closest that like i said off the top of my head code does say that a program of study but if there's somebody who's not doing it they may be out of alignment the code correctly right but i will get those two pieces of information for you and be able to provide it to you there's something else i'll have a directive oh and the other was that

[04:58:15] i was asking for the language what language would we need to change on pages 12 and what language

[04:58:37] should we change on 12 and um sorry uh 12 and 10 if we wanted to clarify that other than that that local divisions have flexibility as to when to offer courses within that sequence okay are you

[04:59:15] referencing the header that says organization and prescribed order of history and social science courses that is that the chart that is before yes that is the section of ordination and prescribed order of history and science courses which it says historically virginia's offer now strongly strongly encouraged so any language we should change there or in the pretty chart the stair

[04:59:49] step chart are you asking us to propose language or um are we taking feedback from the board mr presidents leave even if there isn't a consensus that we want to make that change if we could ask you to propose language that would enact that change that would clarify that local flexibility I could then ask the board to consider tomorrow how about that mr. president thank you mr. president can

[05:00:27] ask a question would it be better suited for us to do that now or wait for feedback from the field? I think on something like this, I'm okay doing it now. It's a relatively minor clarification about where the board would be headed. I mean, I think if the board, you know, said, no, we're not going to make that change, then, you know, the public feedback's great, but it would have to be significant to overcome it, I would think. I think it's good to give some direction to the public on that, see what comes back. I mean, I guess part of me is wondering.

[05:01:05] becomes an issue let's make it an issue you know rather than they you know go out without it having been talked about in this way and maybe have people not respond because we didn't talk about it in this way i i think bringing it up now is a good thing let's just see what comes back and we'll talk about it tomorrow in terms of are we going to make the change to go out but at least it highlights again an area that the board is interested in and concerned about well and i think

[05:01:42] you know this goes to the front matter i appreciate you separating these things out um in terms of our conversations and i i think it would be helpful for my vantage point that certainly is something i could be supportive of um it would assume that you know page nine through um i guess nine through stair step would would remain as a part of front matter and everything before it i mean i've not heard other people speak on their perspective regarding this preface

[05:02:20] question i could certainly support that keeping that section intact to go public if i may just add one point i'm sorry to kind of pivot i just comparing the november to the january version um i do like the restructuring of the skills for each grade you know like removing the bold font

[05:02:53] and it makes it friendlier and the you know rewording has less less of a you know jargon and it's just easier to read so i really appreciate you made it simpler to read for each grade thank you anybody else i i have a process question a couple of comments process question so once we put it out for first review tomorrow if we get feedback like so dr brown was saying she's hearing things these little things aren't clear we want change you know or dr harris gets feedback whatever

[05:03:31] we have to wait till after the public comment process we collect that and we modify but the document that goes out tomorrow has to be is basically locked for the review process for the review for the review process and then we reopen it afterwards that is that correct there's no law or statute that requires no but in terms of how we play it is the practice yes that's how we're going to do it so that everybody across the commonwealth sees the same exact that's what i was getting so it's not a moving target okay so i just wanted to uh be clear um okay a couple of quick comments one i just can't get some of these people are friends and so forth like the words conservative and progressive in education are really kind of meaningless and so like i mean

[05:04:09] the fordham foundation or fordham institute excuse me i don't think i can't speak for all All of them, I don't think any of the senior leadership there is voted Republican since the first part of this century, quite literally. And so I just think we want to be really careful. Like, they do a good job evaluating standards.

[05:04:24] You can agree or disagree with some of their various policies that they support or don't support or whatever. But, like, I'd be very careful to pigeonhole them. I think they're politically, I think they're good at what they do on standards, they don't bring an ideological uh they don't bring a hard political ideological lens to it um second i do think we're probably my suggestion i think we're gonna i'm not in favor of getting rid of all the front matter just like on bunk i think we're gonna have to go through bit by bit and talk about if someone wants to add the gettysburg address to this like i mean i think personally speaking for myself i think that's probably the greatest political speech in american

[05:05:02] history so like i don't i'm perfectly fine with that you know having kids you know not only see it in that but learn it um other stuff i wouldn't want to see come out of there so i think we may just have to go through and probably talk about the intent i was very interested dr manix i hear what you're saying i i viewed the use of the word stain in a very sort of positive way in the sense of like acknowledging the legacy that's with us today and i've actually viewed that as a very important important thing so i think we have to go through and just like talk about these things the one i did want to pause on i hear your concern miss holton i would be very upset if we had

[05:05:37] something in here that said teachers cannot develop individual lessons but the way the entire field is moving right now with good reason is that teachers should not have to develop individual lessons they should be well supported and resourced so i viewed that as like an important aspirational statement and that if teachers want to go above and beyond that's fantastic like the lesson that you described but that we need to end this practice of teachers essentially being on pinterest or google the night before trying to find lessons because they're not being supported by their divisions of the state to produce material and i think that the shift towards making sure we have high quality instructional materials and not just here in the commonwealth but across the country is really important and so

[05:06:16] if you want to clarify that but i actually i found that like a very refreshing thing to see in there that we're going to we're going to better support we're committing to better support and resource teachers there again if there's any concern that that is somehow precluding which i didn't read it that way um we should we should clarify that but the supporting uh making sure there's a floor there for teachers of high quality materials seems like a really important uh thing for this board to commit to as part of this process particularly given that these are pretty content rich and we're going to need to support teachers and and in teaching them all right

[05:06:52] i guess we'll have our work cut out for us tomorrow i i think we're done with the principles and the front matter discussion but i do think there may well be some discussion of other matters Sure. Well, can I just say as a preface, you know, I understand, Mr. Hanson, specifically, that, you know, we took a hit in NAEP scores.

[05:07:17] I mean, we had significant declines, and I understand the idea of a call to action. And this is not arguing for or against, although I personally would not put the front matter in the way it is, but different topic here. I think, you know, we as a board need to be careful about taking things that correlate and saying that there are things that are caused.

[05:07:42] And, you know, the standards hadn't changed since 15, and yet we saw the decline, but nobody is suggesting that it was the standards that caused the decline. And it's not clear to me, honestly, what in these standards, what in the new proposed standards, even if you adopted them as they are exactly, represent, quote unquote, an improvement to the point where scores would all of a sudden increase.

[05:08:08] You know, prior times on the board and, you know, actually bring up Fordham one more time in this. No, because I mean, I respect what they do. I mean, not in a conservative or liberal way. Andy, just. No, no, no, I'm just thinking they probably wish we would just stop talking.

[05:08:23] they probably do which is why they put out the letter saying we're proud of what we did in virginia now leave us alone yeah i i got the message of that letter too but you know when we look at what caused the declines it's not clear to me at least that it's changes in standards because and again let's use standards here in the in the context of standards of learning as opposed to cut scores etc standards hadn't really changed but yet scores declined why well we know during the pandemic, we didn't have enough teacher time, right? That's causal, I think. Certainly

[05:08:59] correlative. I can't prove it's causal, but I believe it's causal. And second, again, back to my Fordham comment, you know, when NAEP scores declined pre-pandemic, you know, I actually talked with Dr. Loving Ryder about this quite a bit. I said, what happened here? Because it was not unique to Virginia. It was a nationwide decline. We had maybe more than some and less than others, but it was clearly national trending and i you know talked to shelley and said did they change the test in a way that caused the decline and shelley assured me and since shelley is you know

[05:09:35] the expert in this i believed her that there was not a change in the test that caused that decline and so i started looking around for other reasons and you know fordham had actually come out with a piece that essentially correlated the declines to the failure of state legislators legislatures to reinstate funding after the oh eight recession to full level and the cohort that was being tested in that year of decline was really the first cohort who had come through without adequate supports in the school divisions and i think as we look at some of this stuff the tendency is to say

[05:10:11] you know gee we make these changes we're going to make it more rigorous we're going to do this and we're going to change outcomes and we lose sight of the fact sometimes and i don't believe it's just money by the way i believe it's how you use the money that matters but we have systematically starved the school divisions of resources since the '08 recession. We have not restored to pre-recession funding levels. And to have us not talk about that at the same time we talk about other things that we might make impact, I think is a mistake because it provides, frankly,

[05:10:45] the political class with an easy solution. And I say that political class meaning both parties, an easy solution because it doesn't require additional resources to fix all it says is we need to change a couple words on these papers and all of a sudden we're going to see things happen differently but we know that that's not right i mean we do know that quality of teaching matters we do know that we have to put the right teachers in front of the right kids and we do know that at this point we do have a call to action for where are we going to get enough teachers of quality to teach our kids to the level that we can expect to see changes in outcomes and i i'm

[05:11:24] not picking on what you said mr hans i hope you don't take it that way but i i do think it's important to look at this i mean honestly if we kept the 15 standards in place i'm going to say this over strongly and we'll end up being slammed by it but you know what would really change in terms of what we

expect for outcomes i gotta tell you i don't think a whole lot maybe on the margin some things there are clearly some things we wish we were teaching that were not but overall particularly in this information age right you know i grew up uh you know jewish kid in the suburbs where did i learn about the history of the jewish people i can tell you it wasn't public

[05:12:01] school right it was outside of that there's enough information floating in the universe that for people who want to learn about certain areas they're going to learn about those areas and you know we are informed enough now as a population that different things are going to seep in you you know, whether they're in these documents or not. And so, I don't know. It just, I get the whole, the concept of the forward laying it all out. I don't see really how it accomplishes the goal we're seeking to accomplish. And, you know, I haven't said it enough since, you know, the new

[05:12:39] members came on the board, which is, you know, our sole question really is, how do we improve outcomes? And everything past that deals with means and methods, right? If I can, if we can, a board improve outcomes for our kids we have done our job how we get there is means and methods part of it may be making some changes to this document uh but a lot of it i think is keeping not only the education community but frankly the political community focused on the resources it takes to actually make changes that we want to see mr president i appreciate that very much i

[05:13:16] you know just when we start talking about resources i can't help but go back to reflect on my 15 years at the federal government and um you go back to 1965 when the great society programs were first put into place to help end the war on poverty and the most important federal programs of the title one program and the special ed program the pell grant program were all put in place to help level the playing field for either our most disadvantaged 8 through

[05:13:49] 12 students, either economically or physically or emotionally, as well as to level the playing field and give opportunity in higher education. And in those last 50 plus years, the two sectors in our country that have had the highest increases in spending have been education and health care. And so there's a lot of different ways you can cut through the spending numbers, but you know, a lot of this is about priorities, you know, we've got a proposal nationally out there

[05:14:29] to forgive, you know, $10,000, $20,000 in student loans that cost a half a trillion dollars, where that money could be, you know, much better spent on, you know, disadvantaged students or other things. So a lot of political arguments out there about, you know, these conversations about where monies can be most appropriately spent. And that is part of, you know, what I think brings us all to the table here is to help improve outcomes and how to get there. But on the preamble or whatever it's being called, I think it's also important to note, I was a young 23-year-old

[05:15:03] staffer at the Department of Education in 1983 when the Nation at Risk report came out. And this was a bipartisan national commission. And it had 37 recommendations in there. But there was a open letter to the American people that probably had one of the most powerful statements, I think, about the educational foundation of our society are presently being eroded by a rising tide of mediocrity that threatens our very future as a nation and a people. And I believe that's where we are as a country. I believe that's where we are as a commonwealth right now. And for us to be

[05:15:39] putting out some, you know, calls to action as part of this, and again, the standards are not panacea but it is all of the above of the standards process our assessment system our curriculum our funding and just really our systemic challenges that we have of a system that is i think becoming more of a

challenge to it's not teachers it's the system and this and so i i do think that language matters i think words matter i think um approach to defining the problem

[05:16:16] that we're trying to solve and how this fits into it matters. And so I feel that I do not read this as political. I didn't read the Nation at Risk open letter to the American people as political. It was a bipartisan. There's other language in there about if what was done to our country's education system was done by a foreign government, we would have considered an act of war.

[05:16:41] I mean, those are pretty strong statements that were led by scholars, led by national leaders to really help define the problems and the challenges that we're trying to address. so again the financial and the budget issues are outside of our domain i think we can you know help push for prioritization of funding to get to those areas that need it the most those students that need it the most and to help level the playing field to help give the opportunity for them to

[05:17:15] to succeed, but this preamble, I really regret the characterization of this and the fact that the President of the United States is quoted in there, and again, I agree with Mr. Rotherham that we can put the Gettysburg Address in there or whatever as well, but lots of other reports out there that sometimes will quote other individuals, but it becomes an anathema when it becomes you know an individual on one side versus the other and so i just i think what's in here actually really helps set the table for a call to action of what we need to be about and whether

[05:17:53] the cause and effects or other issues or what is being considered it's all of the above and we've got to get this right we've got to get these done correctly and this will again set the table for helping us address and i don't know how much of the learning loss or the drop-off is because of the pandemic but the fact is we have a drop-off and so we have to be doing our very best to make sure that we're doing everything we can to get our system in place to help serve our students and our communities and the commonwealth i appreciate that and frankly if you look at nation

[05:18:30] at risk a lot of the issues they raise teacher pay etc are still with us today right so we heard the message and we went in a direction, but we didn't go in the direction that actually implemented what the, you know, cures to the issues that they saw. Ms. Holton, I know you want to get into the minutiae now, so this is your chance. I actually have one process thing and then what you characterize as minutiae, I characterize as important content. Yeah, that's what I meant. The process, the process question, we had a little conversation earlier about how soon can we get a document for the

[05:19:07] benefit of the board and the public that compares the January 23 draft to the 2015 standards so you gave us a crosswalk document earlier in January that compared drafts that are no longer now in consideration August 22 and November 22 setting them aside can we get either a what I call a strikethrough document somebody else had a better language redline a redlining can we either get a red line version from 2015 to January 23 or whatever comes out of I should say

[05:19:43] February 23 because whatever comes out of our meeting tomorrow assuming there aren't significant changes from the January 23 how quickly can we get a document that crosswalks that either red lines and/or otherwise identifies all the crosswalk changes from the existing 2015 standards to what we're asking the public to consider in the public comment um superintendent baylor you want to weigh in before i do maybe just maybe just quickly but we have had a couple of um off offline conversations about this

[05:20:23] and um you know where i first of all let me um let me just acknowledge the the folks who are here plus one other who we pulled in to our team last minute i'm sure he was super happy to spend saturdays and sundays meeting over christmas and on weekends and um and i have to say uh you know as i as i said about our finance and fiscal team earlier uh budget team um we have the best of the best sitting here in this room um they've gone to work and thought carefully about every single line

[05:20:56] and um and word in the standards that are before you for review um that said you know i was very clear after the november meeting we had it up every day when we met and discussed the work the progress of the work that here's the directive from the board we have a very clear directive to and all of us can probably say this by heart to prepare a crosswalk which we did and we sent of the 2015 standards the august standards and the november standards and to take the november

[05:21:29] standards draft standards as a base document fix gaps errors and omissions consider and incorporate where necessary any improvements um based on on information that we received public comments as well as feedback from the board that is what we did if it is the um the desire of this board which i'm hearing again this is sort of a one-off consensus that um that i'm going to say is is there for some kind of strike through or compare document. I think, and I'm going to look back to

[05:22:03] you, Kristania, because I think we can prepare that, correct? Okay. And as far as the timeline, I'm going to leave that to the group of experts. It would take me years to do that. However, these folks are amazing. We need to incorporate any changes. And because this is not my first time going through this process. That's what I'm used to doing is a strikethrough document. And I said earlier that in about two weeks, we could get whatever changes

[05:22:40] that you all want to incorporate. So if it's not overwhelming and even thinking about the things that our team needs to consider um we could probably have both of those documents to you at the same time so i'm gonna i'm gonna give myself about two weeks let's just say by washington's birthday oh i love it when is that president's day commonly known as president's day george washington's day so this is the side by side or the of the 2015 to what we're putting out

[05:23:19] well if you want it side by side we can we can prepare it that way but um the document that i have started has the 2015 standard as the base and anything that has changed is stricken through and anything that is from the january document will be in the standard a different color rather than doing underline because that seemed to be a little much for people to read so for things that maybe been moved around you just have annotations about yes sir yes sir that would be hugely valuable in that time my timeline i mean we're obviously we're not going to have it for purposes

[05:23:59] of our decision making tomorrow correct i'm now focused on will it be ready in time to share with the public in anticipation of public hearings and that your timeline works for that purpose okay wonderful oh so now my content piece did you want yeah before you go to the content so i think what I heard was there was interest in keeping the front matter and some changes in wording. I think that's what I heard. I am prepared to look at that because you know there are some pieces that I

[05:24:32] I definitely you know react to um and I think you know I was I was sitting here really listening to everything that's been said and I think one of the reasons that um this feels um or one of the the reasons I offered the perspective that I've offered is because of the process we've gone through. And if we're wondering why there is reference to political language as I describe my read of this, it is because of the process that we have gone through. And it is the first

[05:25:09] process. In all of my years of service, I've been very honored to serve on the board. I have not felt that level of political weight on the work that we have done from a standards perspective and so i really had to sort of process how i came to those conclusions it might be that people would not have had the reaction that they've had that i've had to this worried not for the process that we have lived getting here so i just i wanted to say that and i will um give some you know

[05:25:48] consideration tonight and if you know those are not things that are accepted i will certainly feel like i've done my diligence in offering up um wording that i think certainly helps to neutralize the impact of the process dr mann thank you for that and again we're the new kids on the block and um you know i think this has been a very unique year um you know with the transition of board members and the governor's office and you know legislative changes everything else so i think just the dynamics of i think it's probably been a pretty static environment for those who've

[05:26:26] been on the board for the last several years and so it has been disruptive but i would hope that it hasn't been politics it's maybe approach or you know i think again i hope that all of our motives are the same to help uh teachers help our students help our families and to help get the best outcomes for where we're going so i i agree and i'm sure from what you've been sitting through for the last several years it has been a very disruptive year so critical critical debate on many things that's not what i'm suggesting i'm suggesting that there is an overlay of vocabulary

[05:27:03] that is used to characterize what has been that is really rooted in political verbiage but i just say that it goes both ways and it's a two-way street of what you know we're dealing with every day out there as well and so the political vocabulary is a two-way street so if i may i'll just i hear you on that but the two-way street is why i'm advocating for if we let the front matter become something that people can use to support in the communications way but not as part of the

[05:27:42] board standard document and you can communicate how you want to communicate about it and the department can communicate how they want to communicate about it and i can communicate how i want to communicate but if we're being asked to put together something that we can all come to agreement on then um then um we can spend some time tomorrow doing some line edits on it i hear mr gecker's suggestion that we try to save line edits for later but that principles document has enough um things that are very problematic for me and certainly and and dr mann and maybe others

[05:28:20] that i would want us to i i i would not be comfortable voting affirmatively i mean the board might as a the board might vote affirmatively but i would not be comfortable voting affirmatively for this draft to go forward with this principles document as is so if i hope that maybe tonight we can all think about both wording changes that might make us be able to come to agreement on it but also what about the possibility of letting it go forward but in some different status not as part of the board endorsed standards and will that meet the purpose so i i just put that out

[05:28:57] there for us all to mull over over the evening um can i now talk about race relations in the 20th century mr president before you do can i just front load this with a little bit a little bit more about what staff did and the work that transpired um that hopefully helps a little bit with some of um some of the process and uh so since the november meeting again we can all we can all of us here can um recite the the board's request to us in november um in addition

[05:29:36] to that you know we we heard loud and clear nuanced um as well as directly stated that this team that's in front of you now lead lead the work and lead the discussions we also heard loud and clear,

again, both formally and in nuance, that we reach out to some of the stakeholder groups that expressed concerns. So almost immediately in November, there were lots of folks in the governor's office, in my office, on this team who engaged in discussions with some of those

[05:30:09] stakeholder groups, including, and not just in conversation, but also consulted things that they had submitted in writing, comments that they had made, etc. Just a few of those groups include the VTEC, the Virginia Tribal Education Commission, the Council, I'm not sure, the Hampton Roads Black Caucus, the Virginia NAACP, the Sikh community, the Jewish community. I know I'm missing a bunch but um but i guess by way of uh you know just just describing um again the the

[05:30:46] business of uh what has transpired between november 23rd ish or whenever it was november 18th and today uh again you know it's it's been um it's been thoughtful work by this team and by the many individuals who have have carefully given input throughout the process so as as we were we're wrapping up work i i called on some of the the specific steering committee members who have been part of this work over the last two years and um and just just assured and reassured them that even

[05:31:23] though we were using the november document as the base document that um that the work was still represented the work over the past two years was still represented and and again that's thanks to this team that every single day said this is what we heard in our groups this is what we heard from stakeholders this is what we heard from the different committees and um and they you know i reminded them often that this is the core team that has remained stable right this work has spanned two years uh we've heard lots and lots of voices and then more voices and then more voices

[05:31:58] It spans to the same board, but two compositions of a board, two governors, two state superintendents, and is transpiring and taking place during a time that on the best of days in the most congenial Lake Wobegon states, history and social standards, social studies standards is still really difficult work.

[05:32:21] And still, I'm not going to say controversial, but it invites emotion and criticism and nuance and really complicated conversations and discussions and a level of professionalism that is remarkable from all entities, including the team that's presenting, as well as those on the board, as well as the many groups that we visited with between November and now.

[05:32:52] So I just want to front load with that and let you know that as hard as the work has been for this team, as difficult as some of the conversations have been for all of us up here and out in our communities, I really do believe and have always believed that this difficult work, these difficult conversations, equal the the best product at the end of the day and and none of us wants anything less for for the

[05:33:23] kids of the commonwealth thank you uh uh miss brown one of the content suggestions i i would like to have us address up front is in second grade 2.9 and second grade is just as we all remember is where we do a little mini united states uh the nation is introduced to our elementary students. And in 2.9, there's some language about, you know, significant historical events

[05:33:56] of our nation's history. There's reference to the War of 1812. I'm proposing that we delete the War of 1812 and instead say the Civil War in that list. And I think it says, among other events, it's not limited, including but not limited to the language. It's something like that.

[05:34:19] I've seen critique in some of the public comment, and I can't remember where, but that War of 1812 is just too darn complicated. There's too much background knowledge required to teach the War of

1812 to second graders. And I'd appreciate your feedback on that and also on whether, as between, if you're going to list one event for the one war, does it make more sense to list the Civil War instead of the War of 1812 in history, 2.2, or any other feedback or thoughts on that suggestion?

[05:34:54] With the Civil War, with all of these, like we said earlier in the presentation, this is setting the groundwork for the curriculum framework. So exchanging any war out would be really thinking about the essential knowledge for the curriculum framework or learning experiences, whichever way we decide to go.

[05:35:22] And the next thought is the Civil War itself, those issues for the Civil War, is that something that we want to tackle with second graders? So with any exchange, whether we leave the War of 1812 here or substitute it out for the Civil War, we have to think about what that essential knowledge is.

[05:35:49] And without simplifying to the point where you either water down something, because you have to think about, we're talking about a seven-year-old, someone who's been on the planet like 96 months, and thinking about the content that a second-grade teacher would need to get across to a student.

[05:36:13] And so my feedback would be not necessarily one for the other, but what do we want to tackle as far as what's going to be in the curriculum framework for the Civil War versus the War of 1812?

[05:36:31] I'm good with either, but that's something that we do need to consider. And is that topic or how would we like to think about the Civil War? Are we talking about the nation splitting? Are we talking about the issue of slavery?

[05:36:49] So the switch out, that would be for the board to make that decision, but keeping in mind, because of this standard, we really do need to think about, as you're making that decision, what's gonna be that essential knowledge?

[05:37:05] Where do you want that to go for a second grade student? - So let me ask this then. so i hear you you're saying i think i hear you saying that civil war may be a little complicated for seven-year-olds is that right i'm here you're saying yeah either one could be complicated so then my question is is war of 1812 also a little complicated for second graders yes and is it too complicated should we just should we leave it to the curriculum frameworks to figure out what event should we just have the front language that says major events in our U.S. history and then let you all figure out at curriculum framework stage which events to list.

[05:37:44] That's a good discussion I think for the board itself, but any war is going to be heavy for second grade. Okay, thank you. Let me introduce my other one and then maybe the board can react to both if I may. So my other one is, you may have seen an email I sent to the board and the department 10 days or so ago uh in which i proposed new language for virginia studies you know virginia studies currently 2015 standard studies harry bird and harry harry bird's one of the prominent

[05:38:23] uh figures of the 20th century that all fifth fourth graders or thereabouts are required to study now and harry bird came out and i'm proposing that we should put harry bird back into virginia studies 10. and i think i proposed some specific language about harry bird and the suppression of african-american voting and economic rights should be batted into virginia studies 10. and then in u.s history 2 and virginia and u.s history could you tell us the page numbers i can tell you the section number the page number unfortunately by the time i did my draft comments

[05:38:58] it all uh changes it's vs10 is my uh and i vs10 in virginia studies and then in u.s history 2 and virginia and u.s history i am proposing language to be added uh which i i'll just read it through well let me just say why i think language needs to be added and and would appreciate miss brown's reflections on whether did you did you see my draft that i sent in not yet with all

[05:39:33] those i mean i actually sent in a bunch of like technical typo type errors no no no i sent it in maybe 10 days ago? No, ma'am. You all got that? I mean, I sent it to the whole board and to the department. I mean, and some of it's just typos and things that need fixing. This is January 23rd.

[05:39:53] January 23rd. So can I ask that the department forward that to Ms. Brown and her team so that you can use that for the typo fixes? But I'll share the language here. But first, the rationale. My rationale is, in my estimation, one of the most significant facts, certainly of Virginia history, but also of U.S. history in the 20th century, is the suppression of African-American

[05:40:28] voting and economic rights from after the brief bloom of Reconstruction through to 1965. And as we all know, voting rights in much of the South were completely suppressed for African-American voters.

[05:40:45] Economic rights were significantly impacted across the country for African-Americans throughout that period. I'm very viscerally aware of it. You all are by nose. My father was elected governor in Virginia as a Republican in 1969. He ran for governor in Virginia in 1965.

[05:41:01] In 1965, the total vote participation in Virginia was 500,000 individuals. In 1969, the total vote participation was 900,000 individuals. That was not because Virginia grew from 1965 to 1969. It was because it took until the 1960s that we lifted the restrictions on African-American and low-income white people voting.

[05:41:25] It was the National Civil Rights Act. There were Virginia decisions overcoming the poll tax. There were a lot of, there was ending of all kinds of economic and political suppression.

[05:41:41] But point being, when I teach my students today, we're looking at higher ed policy. And one of the questions is why is there such a different college going rate and college completion rate between African-Americans and white people?

[05:41:58] And the biggest obvious answer is there's a 10 to 1 wealth gap between black people and white people in the United States today. The income gaps are closing over time, but the wealth gap are still 10 to 1 difference, and that has huge impact in 2023, and you cannot understand that where we are now without understanding that the Civil War's impact on African American success in the United States, slavery's impact on African American success in the United States didn't end in 1865.

[05:42:34] the impact ended in the 1960s. And to get some kind of significant treatment on what happened in race relations between the end of Reconstruction and the 1960s into these standards is, I think, one of the most important content areas that needs to be addressed. There are bits and pieces, but it's not anywhere where it's all brought together. And so I have a paragraph that I've proposed to add, I've had a little language to add to Virginia studies, and then a paragraph to add

[05:43:07] that I'm proposing to add to U.S. 2 and to U.S. and Virginia history in 11th grade or whenever it's taught in high school. And I'm sorry you haven't seen that language yet. I just assumed that the communication I sent to the superintendent would have gone on to you all 10 days ago, but um i i can

share the gist of it here and then maybe the best thing to do is to ask for your feedback on it tomorrow i'd like to know number one is it accurate because this is just my drafting language i mean i've taken input from historians that i've heard from but it's my

[05:43:44] drafting language so is it accurate and number two it help us get the age appropriate place does it belong if the boards decides to add language to this effect is the is it in the right place Should it be in U.S. history, too, and in U.S. and Virginia history, and a little bit of language in Virginia studies, or should it be somewhere else? So those are my questions to Ms. Brown.

[05:44:10] And just the language says, race relations after Reconstruction until the Civil Rights Amendments. The student will apply history and social science skills to understand the major forces impacting African American rights from the late 19th century through the mid-20th century including a examining how jim crow laws violence and intimidation effectively suppressed african-american voting rights and political participation in much of the country b describing the impact of redlining and housing discrimination on african-americans nationwide contributing to wide racial disparities in wealth accumulation in the 20th century c examining the and analyzing

[05:44:48] the mechanisms and impact of educational discrimination on african-americans in education at all levels including higher education and d studying the efforts of african-american leaders and communities to fight these discriminatory actions including the creation of the nacp and so some of these pieces were there were some there were bits and pieces of this elsewhere and i've i'm proposing that we pull it together um and um and so there are some deletions that go with that uh it's not all new content but pulling it all together you know and i'll just say by

[05:45:22] and then I promise I'll stop. I went back recently and looked at the language of the 1902 constitutional debate where Carter Glass, the leader of the group that created the voting rights, says we are doing these changes to ensure that Black people can never vote again.

[05:45:45] And white supremacy, he uses the language, white supremacy will reign supreme in Virginia from here on forward. And that deliberate effect, they were very effective from before 1902, but 1902 through to the mid-1960s, and it has impact today. And I am very passionate about making sure our standards give this history the attention that is due because they have so much impact in how we understand where our country is today. Thank you for bearing with me.

[05:46:19] We'll take that one up tomorrow also, so we have a fairly discreet list of tomorrow things. And it would be helpful, I think, Ms. Holden, I'm trying to figure out how that's different from some of what's under U.S. 2.2, and so I'm struggling, I'm not sure.

[05:46:42] I think it's going to be confusing tomorrow to figure out what, like, as you said, some of this is in there, some of it's in different places. I was having trouble even following some of the sections, so I think we're just going to have to figure out a way to present content so we can actually all... Yeah, so I do have, I did send the draft to everybody, but maybe those pages of the draft we can ask staff to pull forward, or do you want, how can I help make it?

[05:47:08] You're right, there was a little bit of language here and there that I don't think, US-22 did have some of this language. The current language describes, describing racial segregation, including the rise of Jim Crow laws, black codes, and threat to blinds. nowhere in there does it say that we ended african-american voting and economic rights yeah i'm not arguing the point i'm trying to figure out where there's a

lot of content in here and i want to make sure we're not adding content that's i mean one of the things i've struggled with here is just following like where and just make sure we're not adding well be that

[05:47:47] that Section F of U.S. History 2.2 could be subsumed or moved into the section that I'm proposing we create. Right now, it is all sort of lumped in as part of effects of Reconstruction. It's not effects of Reconstruction. It is the chapter after Reconstruction for, you know, 85 years, 95 80 90 years and you know just just to let you know again our process um once the draft the 2023

[05:48:26] draft standards were out the door um i made a pretty clear executive decision that we would not make corrections knowing that there may be typos or changes requested by specific board members in conversations or or by different groups um and and that is really based on the feedback that i received from many of you um as well as the board as a whole in november that some of those last minute changes um were were were not we're not welcomed by uh by board members or the public

[05:49:05] so we did not make substantive or minor changes uh that to to this document once it went public in January. Essentially, we did not want to put the board or staff in a situation where it looked as if we were making changes on the fly based on input from others. So no matter how small or how big, we did not make those changes, any changes. And so once this document becomes the board's document is and is accepted for first review um you know i would ask for a bit more clarification

[05:49:44] and direction on uh on some of especially these more substantive changes we do not need clear direction on fixing typos on fix fixing possessives uh that are are missing or inconsistent on fixing inconsistencies that is that is not an issue we also have a matrix the team has used for years to measure both the frequency and importance and accuracy of changes that are presented and how we vet those and how we put those kind of through a process and decide whether we bring

[05:50:20] them to this board or not we'll continue to use a process for each one that that creates you know from meeting to meeting and stakeholder group to stakeholder group, the opportunity for a parent who writes a letter or gives a comment or a national association who submits a more substantive document or set of requests for these standards. So I think in terms, this is another unique place for this board and for the Commonwealth and for staff to be in that we would appreciate just some

[05:50:56] some thought behind um you know some of these substantive changes um how and when they take place because i i will tell you that changing a document and i i don't think this is what you're requesting but changing a document tonight before it is up for first review tomorrow is just something that i would push back on well i'm definitely not asking for today but i am asking that the board consider these proposed changes along with the others we've identified tomorrow at tomorrow's business session, and then we'll vote them up or down, and then we'll have a first

[05:51:32] review copy. The one thing I would add is that I do think Ms. Duda and Dr. Siebert and maybe others sent some letters with some specifics in too, and frankly, you've asked that we only send communications to you all, to you and your leadership and the board secretary, so I don't copy, Ms. Brown, but I just assumed that you were, since you're looking to her and her team to lead this work, that our content on these matters were being forwarded onto them. And I'm sure Ms. Duda and Mr. Siebert's suggestions, again, some of them were like technical things,

[05:52:11] even though we're not expecting them to make changes. You're absolutely right. You shouldn't be making changes on the draft before the board considers it. But some of them, they ought to be having

that they ought to have those that feedback so they can both be ready to address it with us and be incorporating it into their ongoing draft drafting work so and if if not all of those have been forwarded we'll make sure that they are thank you so in the category of very small changes and i want to qualify what i'm about to say because i think there is an incredible bad faith reading

[05:52:45] happening out there, and it is around this word fascism. I don't think you can possibly read our section on World War II and somehow think that anyone doesn't think we should teach about fascism. I don't think you can read that and somehow think that anyone on this board or in the department or the governor's office is somehow sympathetic to fascism or trying to smuggle it in through these standards. Nonetheless, you can go on Twitter and find lots of people arguing that exact point which is obviously inane but it seems like a really easy one that like if that's the kind of thing again we want to have a substantive i mean especially if president kecker is going to

[05:53:24] go to all of these meetings i want them to be a substantive discussion rather than political theater it's that just seems like a low-hanging piece of fruit i'm almost i am almost reluctant to bring it up because i don't want to give credibility to the idea that this document was somehow because i mean again i think the world war the way the world war ii stuff is written is very very good but it just seems like if that's the kind of thing that's like animating activism on social media we might as well just tamp it down so we can actually talk about some of the more substantive stuff some of which has been already put on the table today that we need to discuss and work through and not have our time consumed by stuff like that okay i think that

[05:54:01] covers all matters great and small i'm not seeing i'm looking for affirmation from the universe that isn't coming. The other thing, we've been on this journey together. We're all intimately aware of it, and it has been bumpy and rocky at times, and there's been dust kicked up, and all kinds of metaphors there. But we've been on it together, so I think we understand it. So just looking ahead on this journey, one of the things that I think wisely had to be done between November and now, what's going to be the February document, whatever goes out tomorrow, was we had to start earning some trust back. A lot of people want to know, why is this not there? Why is it not there? So it was

[05:54:40] this well what's going to be the framework well again i think it was wise that that content is now in the standard so people can't say oh it's not there it's there but from a pure put on my teacher hat there there's just too much content but i don't think that's something we can lean down today or tomorrow and i don't even know how through public comment i think it's going to be a wrestling point it's going to i think the harsh reality is it's very content heavy um i think that was a necessary harsh reality to get to to to where we can move forward and start having substantive conversations. I agree with Ms. Rotherham. I think we need to grab some low-hanging

[05:55:16] fruit to plug into whatever moves forward after tomorrow so we can nip a few debates and try to focus on some things. But I'm just not sure we'll get to that. Looking ahead as people start a chance to wrestling with it, I just really think the way the current standards have always been online by grade level, by section as Word documents, I think that's a very helpful approach because Because we are struggling with which page and which standard and everything else.

[05:55:43] So I know getting the Word document that I was able to receive was very helpful. But if you look at the 2015 standards, how they're organized online, and again, makes them accessible, the whole

nine yards, is breaking them out. And I think that's going to, I don't know how you've done in the past, but I think that's how people look at them now.

[05:56:01] And I think that as a third grade teacher wants to make comment on third grade and as somebody wants to look at all the documents, breaking it out into pieces might help the conversation at the big hearings be more focused. And so that kind of, at some point, making Word documents available for people to work from, I think will be helpful.

[05:56:20] And I think if we make it in bite-sized pieces, again, hopefully we can move toward conversations about the detail we can get consensus on to move on. Yes, thank you. Last thing, I know that some of the discussion that we had had went to make, yes, some of the complaints or the criticisms of this document is that it is too common.

[05:56:51] But how I would push back on that particular point is that in years past with previous standards, we have topics that we fully expected that our teachers in the classrooms were giving full, they were contextualizing those topics pretty significantly, right?

[05:57:14] And I think that this document is doing more to support those teachers in providing that contextualization more than we ever have before, right or wrong. I guess that's an opinion issue.

[05:57:29] But for me, looking at the things that we have talked about before in terms of the numbers of vacancies and other challenges that we have in employing as we move down the road, It is concerning to me if we aren't providing some of that contextualization within these documents to broader, to deepen what exactly we do want taught, very specifically, rather than lending it all to the curriculum frameworks.

[05:58:06] Okay. So we'll do another three or four hours tomorrow, and then we'll go forward. I appreciate everybody's time and comments on this. I'm hoping we're getting this to the point where we've narrowed the areas of discussion for tomorrow's business meeting and that we can come out of tomorrow with a, like I said, not a final draft, but a workable first copy to send out to the public for public comment.

[05:58:33] And although Mr. Rotherham jokes that I'm going to all of them, it is my intent, if I can do it, to be at all of them, to have the consistency across the board for what the comments are. Obviously, it's an area that has generated a lot of interest and is important to us. I can't tell you how really just proud of the entire history team I am for having stayed with this for so long and still managing to smile, Cristania, up at the podium, which is amazing to me because I'm sitting here thinking, how can she possibly be smiling?

[05:59:06] But you are, and even that is appreciated. But the professionalism, the willingness to sort of go down a very circuitous path with these, much more so than, you know, other times we've been through the process without, you know, any at least outward signs of discontent is really pretty amazing.

[05:59:25] And, you know, I look forward to a very high-quality final product when the board comes around in April to finishing this up. But none of that would occur without your work, and that's you collectively here. So thank you all very, very much for what you're doing. Although, you know, I guess there just are no awards for this, but, you know, your service to the Commonwealth in this regard is really incredibly important and exemplary, And it is very much appreciated by me, at least.

[05:59:53] And I think by all members of the board. Thank you all very much. We are going to take a few-minute break, if that's okay with everybody, unless anybody wants to debate that. And we'll be back at 4.10.

[06:00:07] President Gecker, Vice President Mann, members of the board, and Superintendent Melo.

[06:10:31] This afternoon, Deputy Richie, Amy, and I are here to present to you an overview of potential plans and a timeline to reform Virginia's accountability system.

[06:10:48] And as you all know, over the past couple of months, you've had lots of discussions about the need to reform the accountability system. And then in the November meeting, you actually asked the department staff to come back at this meeting with a timeline and a plan to bifurcate on virginia's accountability system so we do have a plan and a timeline for you today um application really determines separating the compliance function of the current accreditation system from the outcome function which is based

[06:11:23] on student outcomes so we'll talk with you today with a plan and a timeline for doing that so accreditation would then become just a compliance and we would have a new accountability system this is intended to be a joint presentation i'm going to go first talk with you a little bit about the old accountability system what the new accountability system might look like deputy ritchie will talk with you about some reasons why we need to change the accountability system and then amy will talk about details um there will be some back and forth um because we

[06:12:00] do want it to be a joint presentation and we will work together to answer your questions so let's look first at virginia's current accountability system and this probably is a familiar graphic for those of you who've been around for a while this does come directly from the soa the standards for accrediting schools and it does describe the various components of virginia's current accountability system right now we consider our accountability system to really have a function of public reporting and it also is intended to derive continuous improvement and

[06:12:35] it's considered currently to have four components the standards of quality that's included because it does lay out essential components of school compliance and the requirements that schools must meet according to the standards of quality. It provides priorities for instructional programs, assessments, and also accountability. The second really bubble is accreditation, and that is our current state system. It is used to identify schools that need support

[06:13:10] and in meeting the state benchmarks. Currently, the accreditation system really has two components there is a compliance component schools are supposed to meet certain requirements in order to receive an accreditation rating and then it has the more familiar accountability component that you all are familiar with it's based on student outcomes the third circle discusses our federal accountability system under essa this is the federal system that's used to identify schools

[06:13:46] for support and improvement and it is currently a slightly different uh set of uh indicators than our current accreditation system and then lastly the last bubble is the school quality profiles that meets our reporting functions and uh there are lots of indicators there that are not included in accreditation ratings but the board in the past has felt that it was important to report those as a means of public transparency so you'll notice there's a bracket to the right and it

[06:14:20] clarifies that really the current accreditation system and our current federal ESSA plan are intended to measure the effectiveness of our programs in our schools and that's also what drives the office of school quality to identify schools that might need support and assistance in meeting those requirements so that's what our current system looks like now let's look at what it would look like with the idea of bifurcation so remember that we talked about the soq or the

[06:14:55] standards of quality uh including primarily compliance requirements it sets staffing standards and the requirements that a school must meet in order to be compliant with the standards of quality so those compliance criteria would would feed into the right hand side where you see accredited accreditation system in the green bubble would be compliance so we're separating the two systems so we have compliance in the first screen bubble and we have accountability in the second so standards

[06:15:30] of quality is just compliance so it feeds into the the green bubble the second blue bubble which is our current accreditation system as i noted previously includes both a compliance component and also an accountability component that deals with the measure of student student outcomes this would be split so when you talk about bifurcation that's really what this would look like so that the compliance criteria the components that a school must comply with in order to be

[06:16:05] eligible for accreditation would move into the compliance component that would be what school accreditation would be in the future and then what is currently part of the s of accreditation that is the accountability component or the measure of student outcomes would move to the new one accountability system third bubble is our federal accountability system it becomes part of the green accountability system so now we have one accountability system

[06:16:39] hopefully that addresses both state needs and federal needs and then our last bubble continues to be the school quality profile so it meets the reporting function both of essa the federal reporting requirements and also the state reporting requirements so you'll see that in the idea of bifurcation we would now have two major components accreditation which would just be compliance but it would deal with compliance in terms of compliance criteria and the standards of quality and also in the standards of accrediting schools and now we would have a new accountability system

[06:17:18] that would no longer include compliance but would deal with student outcomes and would meet the requirements of both the federal and the state requirements so just to tell you what the goal is the goal is by the fall of 2025 we will have a new accountability system in place with a separate accreditation system that will be based just on compliance and this will be based on the

[06:17:49] 2024-2025 data but the first ratings that will fall under the new system will be in fall of 2025 so that's the goal to have a new accountability system with a bifurcated accreditation system by the fall of 2025. right and i'm going to turn it to deputy richie now thank you so much shelley when when you look at the overarching goal of having a best-in-class accountability system there are really three basic components to that and that's what our team has been focused on um you can see from the slide that first and foremost is creating high expectations for all

[06:18:27] students and making sure that our accountability system is based on that on that fundamental principle the second is the inclusion of stakeholders and all stakeholders particularly those closest to the student to make sure that they have the ability to access live usable quality and timely data to be able to make those immediate adjustments on the ground to really improve student student instruction and student performance and then the third and president gecker has talked about this on quite quite a few occasions is that um one of the primary goals as we look at where we

[06:19:04] want to go on accountability is really prioritizing school support so um we have to as a part of our overall process really make sure that as we're examining accountability that we're putting systems and structures in place that are going to allow the department to provide resources and support to schools who need it the most so that they can make the most significant gains where where they are needed as we

move forward we are looking comprehensively at accountability and where we need to go with a new accountability system but we're very much looking at the different components

[06:19:41] of those of that system um what what makes up a system of accountability the input measures to make sure that each of those individual components are also strengthened to improve the overall effectiveness of the accountability system so with regard to accountability what we're trying to do is create a system that is easier to understand it's more transparent and it provides clear and accurate information to parents, to students, to educators, and to the public. Now, with regard to the components that usually make up an accountability system, we're

[06:20:21] looking at four other related issues that will feed into our accountability system. So the first and foremost, which we've talked about before, is making sure that we have a, that we're setting our standards to make sure that students are prepared for success after graduation that includes how we define proficiency but it also includes the cut scores on our assessments what are we what are our expectations through those cut scores on our assessments the second is that we

[06:20:56] are really focusing on examining our assessment system to make sure that we are being intentional and about uh what we assess um what what we're measuring through those assessments but also how those assessments are used um most of you are probably familiar that with house bill 585 which passed last session which requires the state superintendent and the secretary of education to form a task force to look at various issues related to our overall assessment system so as we

[06:21:31] re-examine our accountability system we're also going to be coordinating um with that 585 work group to really make sure that we have the most effective assessment system that we can and that it's producing data that can be uh used by uh by by educators closest on on the ground to really uh drive instruction we want that assessment system to yield usable data and so that we are really looking forward to aligning our work and what we do with the accountability system with

[06:22:03] that 585 uh work group uh third we are really looking at our data systems and how we use our data tools you can see and shelley's office has done great work on this but looking at creating items like parent portals where parents can access data and know exactly how their students are doing but it's really about prioritizing actionable data to make sure that we have the information that can drive instruction on the ground and finally as we look at approving accountability

[06:22:39] this really as i mentioned it includes being mindful about our support to schools and prioritizing our resources and those schools who are in need of support making sure that they do have the resources they need to make meaningful improvements with with their students who are who are underperforming now you guys are well aware of the reasons we're having this this this conversation um you discussed it a little while ago when when you were discussing the the history and the social science standards but um as you know in october of 2022 the nation's report card

[06:23:18] came out with the most recent assessment results that included highlighting Virginia student performance on the NAEP. As you know, in fourth grade reading, we had the largest declines in the country. On fourth grade math, we had a 12-point decline. We were tied with Maryland in fourth grade math for the largest declines in the nation. Our fourth grade declines were three times the national average. And on top of that, only 12% of Black fourth graders performed proficient on NAEP with 19% of Hispanic students in the fourth grade performing proficient. Similar results with regard

[06:23:57] to eighth grade. We declined by 6% in eighth grade reading and a nine point decline in eighth grade math so as as you can see from these results right um we we do have issues with with with regard to how our students are performing you take those nape results and you compare them to our accreditation results you can see the stark differences between student achievement as demonstrated on nape and how our schools and our students perform under our current accreditation

[06:24:33] system so even with the dismal results under nape and and and constantly declining sol pass rates it's clear that the accreditation system is not providing an accurate picture of student performance or of school performance and as a result the message to parents and to educators is that there is no urgency or there is no concern with with how our students are performing um i want to walk quickly through a couple of these bullets because i think they're important to flag for purposes of our conversation today you can see that even with the nate and the declining sol results that we

[06:25:12] have experienced within the state in 2002 or last year every school in virginia was accredited and i also believe that it's true that since we since we adopted this new accreditation system that there has not been a non-accredited school under under this current system so the percentage on top of that right and this is reference to the second bullet the percentage of schools accredited is nearly the same as the number of schools accredited pre-pandemic right so there was no

[06:25:50] fluctuation in our accreditation ratings pre-pandemic and post-pandemic so you can see the the difference in actual student performance. Yes. You're saying you're lumping the accredited with conditions in with the accredited and saying that, right? Yes, ma'am. Because there was actually a 40% increase in the number of schools accredited with conditions pre-pandemic, post-pandemic. Am I right about that? Yes, ma'am. I'm referring specifically to the significance of the drop. Yes, ma'am. That's right. There was a significant increase in the number of schools

[06:26:29] accredited with conditions thank you for that pre and post okay yes ma'am thank you and i was also confusing it with the chart that i had here which is the historical look at at the the accreditation picture thank you for clarifying that but before we move on i i do want to and i'm hoping that amy will will chime in here i i do want to focus in on that that last bullet because i think that it's i think that it's it's it's informative right when when we talk about and and we we make statements like um our our accreditation system is not yielding transparent results for the public

[06:27:04] this is an example of what we mean by that on that bottom chart in in in the right hand corner because our accreditation system uses a combined uh rate right which is not the same thing as the annual pass rate or the actual student performance on sol results there is a discrepancy in how students are actually performing versus what the accreditation system reports so you can see in those examples um school a on reading and math and school b on on reading and math the difference in

[06:27:39] how students are performing versus what is reported out under the current accreditation system so it's it's it's a very clear picture um the the current system is just simply not conveying how our students are actually performing and it's it's masking their their their current performance i want to just look quickly um and and and reference the governor's report um which which details specific actions that we can take to make improvements we know are necessary to really

[06:28:12] restore educational excellence as we move forward um this plan does align with with goals relating to assessment and accountability this goes back to raising expectations for all students action number four involves overhauling and addressing the significant or overhauling and addressing our

accountability system and the creation of a new accreditation system and really just making sure that through the adoption of that new system that we're really holding ourselves and our schools

[06:28:45] accountable for for our performance um on top of that um what we are focusing on is putting systems in place as i've mentioned that that really do improve data quality and making sure that that we have access to to high quality data that is going to lead to school improvement on the ground so as a part of the work that amy is going to detail um next we really have come up with four guiding principles that are leading our work and uh you you can see those on the screen first and

[06:29:22] foremost the the north star is high expectations for every student we are looking to set proficiency definitions looking to set cut scores um that align our expectations with the highest performing uh states in the country um and those states that have the most rigorous definitions of of proficiency number two we're really looking at focusing on transparency and rigor increasing um the the rigor of our of our accountability system but also really looking at it access to actionable

[06:29:57] actionable information number three um looking at student growth and proficiency together right but making sure that our priority is student proficiency making sure that we're setting a high standard for every student and making sure that we're giving teachers the tools that they need to to get students to that proficiency measure as as as most of you know one of the challenges with the current accreditation system is that the growth the way that we calculate growth tends to mask the actual student performance the way that we look at growth um outweighs and is is

[06:30:34] more heavily valued than than than proficiency so that's something that we want to look at they're both very important growth is important and so is proficiency but proficiency has has to be our our guiding light um number four the purpose of accountability is really to build trust between schools and parents uh we've said this before the accountability system should not be a hammer it should not be a way that we go into schools and and and say you're you're not hitting the mark it it should build trust it should be our mechanism to identify schools that most need our help and then for us to have the resources and the support um and and go and partner with

[06:31:12] those schools to collaborate to collaboratively uh work to um to lead to school improvement and and finally um our guiding principle uh one of our guiding principles is really going to be to prioritize stakeholder input we want to hear from educators from parents from families from those in the higher education community from those in in in the business world um we want to hear what um what we can do to make sure that our kids are ready to succeed in in in life after graduation and in in in the post-secondary world um as as shelly mentioned um the charge from this

[06:31:51] board uh at the november meeting was was to come back and present a plan and a timeline and um we uh amy as i mentioned is going to go into specific details about the plan but um i i do want to lay out the the general premise and then i will pass it over to amy to to go into more detail our recommendation to the board is that in order to meet the guideline or the the timeline that that shelley referenced at the beginning of the presentation which is to have a new accountability

[06:32:26] system finalized by the fall of 2024 so this would be august of 2024 so that all schools know what the rules are start at the start of that school year um what we're recommending to the board is that we accomplish this work in two different phases and you can see the outline of the phases on on this on this specific cream on screen phase one involves immediate changes that this board can make to the existing accreditation system that will cause more

[06:33:02] transparency and more rigor within the existing system these changes can be made without regulatory or statutory changes they are recommendations or actions that this board can take under its existing authority and and these changes would take effect for the 23-24 school year so no changes to the current school year that we're in but there would be changes under phase one to next school year

[06:33:33] the 23-24 school year the second part of the plan is that as we are as we are implementing phase one and trying to put into place immediate uh changes to the accreditation system to improve transparency and rigor we would also be concurrently working on phase two which would be the long-term planning for a new accountability system and a standalone accreditation system that aligns to more uh of what other states have with regard to their accreditation systems which is a a system based

[06:34:13] on regulatory and statutory compliance so in phase two we're looking at that long-term plan for what the new accountability system is going to look like but we're also making the changes that we need to make to stand up a compliance-based accreditation system and that completion date as shelly mentioned the completion date for phase two um would be um the fall of 24 and would take effect for the the 24 25 school year with those new accountability determinations coming out in

[06:34:48] september of 2025 did i get the date wrong thank you fall of 25 thank you yes did you have a question yeah i'm reading it yeah thank you wait a minute no yeah that's right that's right thank you so we we have had this we've had this confusion the accountability year is different than the school year so yeah so amy i'm going to hand it over to you yeah and i think um one of the things that kim was referencing is that we're trying to get the information to the schools prior to the

[06:35:23] start of a school year so they know how they're going to be evaluated that next fall so that may be also where some of the confusion is all right so i am going to um go through some of the milestones that we have laid out these first slides are laid out by phases by phase one and phase two and then i have some information on some work that's going along in tandem with it

[06:35:57] and then after that there's a timeline that kind of shows how these two phases are actually overlapping and how how the work will overlap so um with um phase one of course today we're presenting the plan in the timeline for you to review and then in april the board will be presented with the first review of the revisions to the current accreditation system so these will

[06:36:30] be the changes that we recommend um to the the current model that will be in place when school starts next year in 23 24 and then will be uh in place in all of 24 if we provide accreditation rating um these just to go into a little bit more about these revisions to the current accreditation system as kim said these are changes that the board has the authority to make

[06:37:01] already such as adjusting benchmarks on the current indicators adding indicators or using special provisions to possibly not use an indicator so things along those need along that those lines are things that the board already has the authority to do so we will outline those for you in april then in May there is no meeting so the timeline bumps to June and in June we

[06:37:39] will present the final review of those revisions to the current accreditation system and then in June there's also a bullet that mentions the office of school quality will continue their ongoing work to support schools and as Kim mentioned earlier this does include planning and preparing for the changes in their processes or their procedures or their organizational structure that may be warranted to support the schools that are identified with the new Phase 1 and Phase 2, anticipating that there

[06:38:17] will probably be more schools that will need support in the identification process. Then in summer 2023, department staff will communicate to all school divisions, make sure we're informing them of the changes we will be seeking input from constituency groups as how to best prepare divisions for the changes to the accreditation model that they'll see in fall of 2024 and then in october 23 department staff will begin the internal work to update the design of the school

[06:38:53] quality profiles the technology and systems development staff will have to begin updating their programming to reflect the phase one changes and there is also a lot of work to be done on the accreditation detail reports that we provide in ssws there's a lot of reports that are going to need to be amended and then of course in september 2024 that's when the accountability determinations are made based on the phase one changes

[06:39:30] all right the phase two milestones um there's quite a few of these but um we have highlighted march through september as the timeline for development of the new accountability system and the accreditation as compliance system so we will be soliciting guidance from consultants and we will be conducting regular outreach we will be soliciting feedback from stakeholder groups with multiple meetings taking place throughout that time period that includes superintendents

[06:40:04] division leaders teachers parents business leaders and educations there will also be multiple internal videoe meetings with the relevant departments that will be impacted by the forthcoming changes and the department will also be providing monthly updates to the board regarding our progress on the development of this new system we currently have october 23 as the target date to present the the new accountability system and the new accreditation

[06:40:41] right then um this next slide indicates the time frame in which any legislative or regulatory actions are need to be taken or may need to be taken to make the permanent changes to the accountability system so in april 2024 if needed and assuming the the process proceeds as we anticipate it will um bills separating the accountability and accreditation systems

[06:41:20] and enacting the new accountability system will be passed by the general assembly and again that's if that is needed and then in june and july would be the board's first and final reviews of any new regulations to that be necessary and then in july and august of 2024 again we'll be communicating to school divisions so they know how they're being evaluated in that

[06:41:48] 24 25 school this next slide indicates the target dates for bringing the new essa accountability model to the board for first and final review because our consolidated state plan will need to be amended and it will be need to be resubmitted to the u.s department of education for approval that will have to come to the front of the board and that is october and november and then the last

[06:42:25] date september 2025 is when the new accountability system will be used to assign ratings to schools and the new accreditations will be based on meeting compliance measures it is it's really important to note here that the new accountability system will be incorporating the new and more rigorous cut scores for reading and math the uh next slide that we get to will show the milestone dates for the assessment related activities that um kim had talked about earlier and that will

[06:43:02] include the board's review so on the assessment related milestones we have information about the stakeholders group that's being convened as a result of house bill 585. kim mentioned this in her

remarks that stakeholders group was part of legislation that occurred in the 2022 session so that that committee will convene in march and they will begin working on their

[06:43:36] recommendations to changes to the current assessment system then in october of 2023 um the department will convene standard setting committees for the reading and mathematics tests to recommend higher cut scores that are aligned to nape proficient and high performing states so that will occur in october in november we're back to discussing the committee for house bill 585. this is a long-standing committee but its initial report is due to the general assembly in

[06:44:14] november of 2023 then in march of 24 the board will have first review of those more rigorous cut scores for the reading and mathematics sol tests and then final review and adoption in april of 2024. so because assessment and accountability is so intertwined we wanted to make sure you all were aware of the assessment related milestones as well i'll give it back to amy can i just ask you know know, we've talked before about having sort of growth-related assessments in the Commonwealth

[06:44:47] more than we have today. Where are we in that process? You know, actually measure individual student growth. I mean, now we sort of use test scores as a proxy, if you will, for how well the schools are doing. And, you know, it's okay, but it doesn't take into account different demographics.

[06:45:06] I mean, there's flaws with that model, right? I mean, the fact that you have a school with higher performing kids does not necessarily mean the teaching is better there. It may mean that the demographics of the school are such that you have higher scores. I don't know, four years ago, Ms. Holton? How long ago has it been? This is not about the current VDOE leadership. It goes back to the past VDOE leadership. The board has pushed for growth measures. We were told it was in process And, you know, candidly, I don't think, you know, it just got off the ground.

[06:45:45] But it seems to me that, you know, particularly in light of the secretary's background, that having Virginia's interest in, you know, developing legitimate growth measures would be good as you move forward talking about changes in the accreditation and accountability systems so that we can have just better measures of, you know, more accurate measures of what it is we're trying to have schools do.

[06:46:11] so mr gecker um based on legislation that occurred in the 2021 session we were directed to create virginia growth assessments you you may remember a discussion about those probably in the summer of 2021 um those assessments are given um to students in grades three through eight in reading and mathematics they're given in the fall of the year and this this year they're also given in the winter of the year. And then we have the regular SOL tests that are given in the spring.

[06:46:47] And 10 of those assessments was to provide a measure of growth across the year. We are still working on exactly how that looks because this is this year will be our first experience of having an assessment in the fall that measures content that the student is going to be taught that year.

[06:47:07] So in other words, a fifth grade student took a growth assessment that measures fifth grade content. so i think um we have certainly been working on a growth assessment as ms holton knows um you know we we have been we created a vertical scale so that all of our assessments are linked together so that we can measure growth from one test to another and that vertical scale is also used for the growth assessment so that was an attempt to measure individual student growth we even added

[06:47:41] items that measured some grade two content for students in third grade so that was our attempt to get at the the request for individual student growth so without prejudging what this will end up

looking like would it be your intent to use in terms of this model growth measures or just sort of passing rates on sols well even before we had the growth assessments we used individual student growth and we were looking at the student's score on the sol test from the previous year

[06:48:16] to the current year and we were looking at how much that student moved on that vertical scale so even looking spring to spring it's still an individual measure of growth not not at the school level does that help mr gacker i think so i'm 100 sure but i'm thinking it through i i have questions about growth measures is now a good time or do you want to go on to the rest of your Oh, I probably interrupted too early. Let them finish and then can we do it then?

[06:48:45] Yeah, absolutely. I'm sorry about that. I didn't know if they were done yet. Well, I just have a couple more slides. This is kind of a thorough representation of the timeline milestones to show how the work on both phase one and phase two are going to occur concurrently. I don't know what they look like up there. They look kind of red, orange. I'm not really sure what color they are that you're seeing but the ones um above the line are the phase one

[06:49:19] milestones and that green um box and the following slide boxes that are below the line are the phase two milestones and then there's also some boxes that are in black and and those are the related activities that we've been talking about in terms of household 585 and et cetera that um are shown on the timeline so as you can just see by this particular timeline that this first year 2023 is going to be filled with stakeholder involvement we're working with consultants

[06:50:00] on our revisions to the system or to the to the systems the offices of accountability and assessment our technology and systems development our data services offices of school quality just we will be immersed in the work related to this initiative so by august phase one will be developed and communicated out to school divisions so that they have the information prior to the start of the 23 24 school year and then by october phase two will be developed and presented to the board

[06:50:39] one thing that i do want you to note on this screen is that the accreditation ratings in spring 2023 will not be impacted by any of these changes so the ratings that are assigned to schools in fall 2023 will be based on the current nation and then on this slide it's important to note that the phase one changes will be implemented with the september 2024 accreditation ratings and then on

[06:51:16] the bottom you can see that there still is quite a bit of work that's going on in 2024 for phase two and any legislative or or board work that may be necessary to finalize the changes will be completed by july of 2024 our essa consolidated state plan should be approved by november 2024 and then you'll see a break in the timeline then our new accountability and accreditation

[06:51:48] compliance system should be implemented in september of 2020. and then this last slide i i know we keep we've said it several times but just to kind of get the years so that everybody is straight is just really a review of the transition that for the 2023-2024 accountability year which is based on this year's data this current year's data there will be no changes in accountability

[06:52:24] year 24-25 which will be based on 23-24 data that those accreditation ratings will be based on the changes that are made in phase one and then in the 25-26 accountability year which is based on the 24-25 school year data the new system open it up to questions and discussion and before you get to

[06:53:02] yours if you don't mind let me dismiss with shelly i mean how does the growth factor in i mean in terms of because i want to make sure i understand what we're actually what we actually did uh i mean

just take the english right we have a 75 pass rate in english uh to hit level one right or a three-year average rate of 75 so how does or there's a reduction in failure rate component to it how does that take into account individual student growth so on english we use what's

[06:53:38] called the combined rate. And so, if students pass the SOL test, they're counted. If students fail the SOL reading test, but they show sufficient growth and that's designated amount of movement on that vertical scale, they're also counted in that combined rate. I think that's some of the concerns that have been expressed because growth for a failing student is counted the same as a pass.

[06:54:08] I mean, I know there's an issue as to weighting or whether the growth should count, but by and large, we're using for the 75% pass, so pretty static. You know, and it's, I mean, the kids who comprise that change every year. And then, Mr. Gecker, just for transparency, there's a third component.

[06:54:26] So if we have English learners who don't pass the SOL test and they don't show growth in the SOL test, but they do show progress in learning English, they're counted. So it's really, for English, there are three ways that a student could be counted positively in that school's combined rate.

[06:54:45] Okay. Again, every year, the students who comprise that sample set change, right? Yes. So we're not really measuring, if you will, the three-year average year-over-year growth of an individual student.

[06:55:02] No, no, no, we are. But you are measuring year-over-year growth in that combined... Year-over-year from a trailing year, trailing to current. in the combined rate you are looking at growth from year to year but but not current you know test year to the year after how are they factored in and says yes i believe her but i just i think so so like john smith takes the math sol at the end of third grade and then he takes it again at

[06:55:36] the end of fourth grade and we are looking at his growth from grade three to grade four you know if if you move schools or God knows all of the complications. But as long as they stay in Virginia, we track them because we have a student testing. And you count that growth towards the second school.

[06:55:54] Right, for the preceding school. Right. So I have a number of questions, but particularly about the growth is now a good time to jump in. Yes, now it is. You have made progress, I do. We have made progress on growth measures, but they're still awfully clunky.

[06:56:13] And if I understand correctly, for instance, We give no credit when the advanced students grow. So if you're already passing, but then you're passing really high, in other words, growth only counts. We only count growth for students who fail the proficiency.

[06:56:32] Currently in the definition of the combined rate, which is one of the things you all decided on. We're counting growth for failing students. So we're not counting growth for, we couldn't figure out a way with our current measures to measure growth for all students.

[06:56:47] We only measure it for, and I think this is one thing that the HB 938 task force was emphasizing. We should figure out a way to look at growth for all students. Another thing we're not doing is we're not looking at growth of first graders or second graders or kindergartners or 9th, 10th, 11th.

[06:57:04] You know, we're basically, and that's all because we're just working with what we could do with our current testing system. were essentially jerry-rigging growth measures out of an sol test that was designed to be a proficiency measure not a growth measure well and i know you've heard me use this analogy before but test items are a little like legos you can configure them in different ways so even though

our sol test items were initially intended to be part of a proficiency measure we are able to reconfigure so that we can measure growth particularly with the vertical scale and

[06:57:41] do you mind if i so please so i think another thing about measuring growth for advanced students is in our current model i think you all are all aware that it is computer adaptive so this year there is a change in the algorithm so that we are able to pick up above grade level items and below grade level items this is the first year we've ever been able to do that so before it was just a grade level test. Now we are able to pick up below and above grade level items. So that gives

[06:58:14] us more of a range of scores. But we do still have difficulty measuring the growth of students who are performing really, really well because they top out. You are correct that we've had trouble doing that. And we're not measuring growth in any of those other grades, you know, K through three grades in elementary, you know, and we're not measuring growth in any subject other than literacy and math. So my question, my big picture question is, what are other states doing in there now? We do have board members that may have some knowledge on this basis,

[06:58:48] on this topic, and Superintendent Balo may, and certainly Secretary Gadara. What are other states doing that are doing a good job of, I mean, I feel like we've been jerry-rigging growth measures, and we're doing a lot better than we did before, but both in how you measure growth and then how you use growth to factor into your accountability accreditation system, what states are doing it well and how do we get from where we are to where they are? That's a big picture question I realize.

[06:59:20] If I could, Mr. President, I will give like a super high level answer to that and then rely on Shelly to give an additional answer, but having been part of accountability overhauls in Wyoming, I will tell you that the most substantive discussion that we've had with experts from across the country about what you're saying now is thinking about value-add, and that is a super complicated and complex and state-specific and sometimes group-specific

[06:59:54] conversation i know in the state that i was in before it was very group specific at first we only applied it to our students who were in alternative schools and um you know recognizing again what what we've been discussing we know that when we only measure proficiency there are flaws we know when we only measure growth there are flaws we also know that when we equate proficiency to growth, that's problematic as well. So there's no easy fix or there's no let's do what this state

[07:00:30] is doing or let's do what this expert says. It's a lot of discussions with a lot of people who have tried different things, but I will tell you that value add seems to be a key component of growth measures. And I'm speaking really big picture, but I know as we go down this track and as we think about how important it is to recognize the growth of our students and how important it is to recognize the proficiency, I think we need to have some conversations about how to break down that,

[07:01:06] how to break that down into a formulaic way that really shows and does not disregard the schools that are showing great growth, but maybe not great proficiency, and also doesn't inflate the schools that have really great proficiency and don't need to show a whole lot of growth because of their demographics or what have you.

[07:01:32] Am I right, Ms. Baylow, that some states are actually using a different assessment? I remember being schooled on this some years ago, that there are some assessments that are intended to be more

formative growth assessments. And I don't understand the details of this, but a different kind of test than a proficiency test.

[07:01:56] And that some states are actually administering different tests as measures of growth separate from their, or is that wrong? And I guess I'll ask a related question.

[07:02:12] How about the smarter balanced and the part test, those, are they better able to measure both growth and proficiency than our SOLs? Again, this is a lot of big picture. Now you're testing my memory to remember your questions. Okay, so I think, first of all, as far as other measures, we have certainly had the student growth percentiles here in Virginia, and Dr. Siebert and I both probably have a little PTSD over that.

[07:02:42] That measure is one where you're comparing students to like students, And the problem we had in Virginia was because we allow so much acceleration in math, you then had, you were comparing the students who were taking Algebra I in the sixth grade to all of the students who took Algebra I in the sixth grade.

[07:03:02] So it was a very narrow comparison. Smarter Balanced is a computer adaptive assessment like ours. I don't really know very much about their growth measures. I'm not aware, in fact, that they have any growth measures built into their test.

[07:03:22] PARC is not a test that I believe would allow the measurement of growth. So what about something like the PALS? I'm told the PALS is a growth measure for pre-K through two or three. So one of the responses I was going to give to you is as we begin to look at all of these new early childhood assessments, I mean, maybe there's a way we can look at linking data on those assessments to the SOL test to determine a measure of growth.

[07:03:52] Have I answered all of your questions? Did I miss some? Yeah, and I'm really just being very high level at this point. I will have to say, I would be the first one to say that, you know, I'm not trying to say that what we have is perfect or even a really good measure, but it is something we've worked on over a couple of years.

[07:04:12] And one value in it is that teachers have a clear understanding of where students need help. You know, we're using the SOL test items, so they are measuring the content that teachers are supposed to test every day.

[07:04:28] I think some of what you're hearing about other states, Ms. Holt and his states that may be using NWEA map or some other growth measure for to measure growth. That's that's what I'm hearing. Yeah. And I think that's something we should look at. of the issues there is that you've also got to have a measure of proficiency to meet federal requirements. And then you've got to give more tests. Right. A quick question. I mean, this is such an important topic and it relates to the building of information portal systems and tools. And so as I was listening to that segment of the presentation, I was

[07:05:04] suddenly trying to picture what kind of information are we giving parents access to? Because i mean i perceive and certainly as a parent of students who've gone through virginia schools teachers have real-time access to information on how students are doing because they're there every day and i'm just really curious about what else is going to be accessible to them sol tests

[07:05:39] are in the course unless there's and i know there was some introduction in some of the early grades to do testing more frequently but i am curious to just kind of appreciate what else are we envisioning providing that's going to be real-time access to making actionable changes like in the moment for this student right now i just can't like wrap my mind around a state structure doing that in quite the same way that schools should be on top of this so i'm just curious

[07:06:16] for examples of what that what might be beneath that expression may i respond mr gecker so with the advent of the growth assessments which are three through eight reading and math we created a parent portal for those tests and now we've also added the sol test so within a week of a student taking a growth assessment a parent can log in to a portal and see the results of that assessment and what is provided is a student detail by question report so it gives a description of every item the student took whether that item was low medium or high difficulty whether the

[07:06:55] student got it right or wrong and there for most students there's also a video that goes along with that presentation that for that particular student describes what is in that report and then we also have a link within that portal to our website for resources that parents can use so while it does include just test results at this point i think that would be the beginning of a portal that you know could provide additional information of course there are many school divisions who have their own portals but that's just an example of one that we have provided at

[07:07:31] the at the state level but the expectation with this new system is that across the commonwealth there's going to be some standard access to this kind of information for all students and that districts will well i guess a district doesn't necessarily need to opt in to anything you're just making the information available to parents with resources that parents can access to i think that's right dr manon you know one of the things that we're talking about now even with legislators

[07:08:08] is how to expand that parent portal right how to make it more usable how to make it more accessible and that's certainly something that we want the 585 group um to think about as they look at the overall assessment system right how can we make sure that there's a component of whatever assessment system we need to move forward with that provides that kind of um usable timely data to both educators and parents.

[07:08:36] So, I mean, it's very much where we would like to go and the direction that we would like to move forward with, specifically having that 585 group look at that even more. For the parents that lack access to the Internet and technology, and, you know, where and how will this endeavor bridge that divide?

[07:08:56] Because if this is being provided through that means and you have families that lack Internet access, I mean, I'm sure those are things you all are thinking about. Dr. Mann, one thing we've done is the current parent portal is accessible through a cell phone.

[07:09:12] And we find that most parents do have cell phones. And we were very careful to make sure that everything was visible on the cell phone. Ms. Rothman, did you have something you were about to say? No, go ahead. I have a question.

[07:09:28] I think it's kind of quick. And then I'll follow up with some thoughts and observations from my colleagues. Where in this timeline is the RFP for our assessment system? I was in House Committee the

other day, and we've got an extension now, but still there's a window here, and we've got to go out for bid, and where we then have to know what we were going to ask for in the RFP.

[07:09:49] Because this is getting to some of these other things here that I'll get at in just a moment. Yeah, it's a great question. I'll start, and then I want Shelly to weigh in. As I mentioned, we are looking comprehensively at every aspect of the accountability system, and that includes our assessments.

[07:10:05] of course the the work that the 585 committee is going to be doing we would ideally like for that committee to be able to complete its work submit its recommendations to the general assembly before we are able to go out or before we have to go out for another assessment rfp under our own authority we can extend the current assessment contract through december of next year so we have the authority to at least build it out that much but we have been working with other state agencies and even with with members of the general assembly um to make sure

[07:10:42] that that we have that authority to even extend that more if if we need to um we we want that work we want that housewell 585 committee to finish its work submit its recommendations before we have to move forward on that on on issuing that that rfp and of course we will utilize those we will utilize our existing authority to extend that out as as far as we can but we may need assistance from other agencies um and and the general assembly to to push that out even further you have anything you wanted to add and the reason i think that's important is truly um

[07:11:19] virginia was a pioneer with student assessment and and so the original sol tests um we predated no child left behind and so we were a pioneer in that and because we were out front and build a lot of our own we have continued to build on what we've built and and and that it's been powerful and and what the staff and previous boards have done with the current tools to tweak them and amend them and change them has been amazing and commendable but we are reaching we've reached in my opinion a long time ago a number of limits yeah you can assemble the legos in lots of ways

[07:11:54] the legos are still ultimately square with sharp edges and and at some point in time and i got two students two children and in engineering legos are powerful for them but at one point they had at some point they had to move from legos to lego technic you know and some some projects they wanted to they wanted to solve they had to use connects my point is that there had to be multiple tools multiple building blocks for different purposes and you'll be a child of an 80 of the 80s i often think about my stereo system in my dorm room you know i wanted a component system i wanted the best tape deck i could get and when i want to take that tape deck out and swap it in with a dvd player i

[07:12:28] want to do that while keeping my amplifier you know these are all so so i think long term we've talked about best in class and how do we even define that but ultimately if we want to get really really good with assessment and accountability in commonwealth virginia the assessment needs to be linked to different factors the developmental stage of the child so using the pals and things in primary grades um the way we want to assess new history standards might require different tools than what we might do when we do the math standards which is probably different than when we do the language art standards so so really thinking about what is the the box of tools we want for those kinds of things and this is why i'm glad this will be years

[07:13:06] long work but this is still a very very tight timeline even though it's thankfully longer than originally thought about timelines because there's a lot to do some some just this is for the pool dialogue we're not going to solve this today for the pool dialogue we're going to think about what are going to be our

our thresholds i mean already we're feeling the complexity and the issues of using nape proficient versus the fact that there's also nape basic and originally the sols were intended to be a measure of basic skills over time we raised cut scores to try to get more college career readiness and then test scores and cut scores of ebbed and flowed lots of issues there

[07:13:42] but um you know we use pass pass advance and fail um but maybe when you think about using uh advanced proficient basic and below basic you know maybe we need if if when you think about some of those things. I think we also need to think about the tests. Great conversations here about growth measures. And so, yes, you can use an achievement measure at points in time to look at growth. And so their student growth is the collective number of students in the school. How did they do? And that's currently how it grows in accreditation and combined rate. But there's still the aching desire of parents and of teachers to celebrate the progress that every individual child made.

[07:14:19] Now, again, part of the PTSD, Shelley and I share over student growth percentiles was student growth percentiles could not be used with our Legos at the time because we had a ceiling. There's only so high our Legos could build. And so we needed to have stretch and things. That's also the problem we have right now with this, again, well-intentioned student growth process, grades three through eight. We still are having to use test navigator. We're still having to sign our test usage agreements. We're still having to shut down either hallways or schools for that grade level to take that test. You have to have all the proctors out in force. And so it is an

[07:14:55] onerous process to get that little bite of data three times a year, again, using our existing system. The fact that it's been built is commendable and powerful. But there are so many other tools that can get that information so much quicker with so much less burden. The problem, the nice thing in Virginia, because I'm always over for local control, we've had a lot, because this was a need the localities have been meeting that need in different ways some are using benchmark assessments that are collaborative some are using the map test some are using iReady people are using different tools so there's been this divergent evolution of growth measures and that's been

[07:15:31] great because the schools had to have the growth measures not for accreditation or accountability but measuring where every individual child is what do they need how can we adapt um give the test on in november give it whenever you need again just think about how how where you need it so now you have divisions with years of experience and wealth of data and the tools they've selected or built or acquired um and how do we start to fit some of those things back together so it is this is no small task but at some point at some point um we've done a tremendous job of building on and changing what we've got i just believe at some point we have to conceptually decide what

[07:16:11] would we ultimately like to have and build backward for that put it in rfp and i think the commonwealth of virginia we would have lots of respondents to it on how to do it and again it might be multiple respondents it might be you know that that you have to use different tools for different purposes but they're all compatible using our student test identifier to help meet these needs this is this is big big big work but this is exciting work and i think it's the enduring legacy work that um that will go a long time in in general the sol tests as we still largely know

[07:16:47] them even though they're on computers now even though they're technology enhanced items they are still the vestiges of a problem we solved in their in the 1990s we solved that problem we have new problems now and so we got to think about different boxes of tools anybody else first of all great

presentation thank you very much this is uh really a lot of information to process and i'm sure it took a long time and i really appreciate the timeline that you put in together in all of this so great job very exciting like uh dr siebert said very exciting um i had a couple

[07:17:27] of questions which dr mann alluded to earlier you said currently there is a parent portal and so where is it is it on the state website or is it in the local divisions available also so many school divisions do have their own parent portals but the one i was referencing is actually available through the Pearson system. Pearson is our current testing vendor. And so the parent portal is available to parents through that system. And each school division is responsible for giving parents access to that portal. There's a claim code that parents have to be provided.

[07:18:04] And how long has that been? Fall of 21. A couple of years. Well, just over a year. over a year yeah okay i had not heard of that so it it's only available at this point for students who are in grades three through eight and it may be that you have older children okay three through eight okay we are beginning to expand it but that was the beginning of it um you mentioned learning uh learning needs dashboard portal in one of the slides um is that also planned as a like a vdoe

[07:18:40] or state tool or is that going to be incorporated or have would the local divisions have an interface to that one of the slides mentioned a learning needs dashboard portal yeah which and miss done this this is part of um again a part of what governor youngkin outlined in the commitment to virginians report and it's what i was referring um to with dr man in her question about it is a

[07:19:19] priority for us to expand the current parent portal and even create additional opportunities like this learning portal like this dashboard for parents to be able to navigate and access student information including including assessment results it's something that we will work with on the 585 committee as we look at the whole assessment system creating these types of dashboards and creating these types of new systems is where we want to go um and and something that

[07:19:54] will be a priority for us moving forward so it could be like a next gen for the existing portal i think so shall we do you i don't yeah i think so i guess that's not important but yeah so okay and a quick question about the bridging the gap i'm again mentioned one of the slides 15 uh trying to raise it from 15 to 25 school divisions um so is that is that would that be using the esser funds or how is that bridging the gap increasing the number of school divisions going

[07:20:29] to be accomplished i'm not sure the funding source superintendent for you it's the bullet that's right up there so i think so i think the question is there's a current bridging the gap um pilot that's going on and the idea is to expand the number of divisions i think ms dada is asking what the funding source is i just don't know i'm not sure okay all right that's fine um then there was another place i wish i'd written out which which uh um slide i saw but you mentioned

[07:21:05] stakeholder input that might be the next slide is the and you mentioned that the vision is for you know the current current um you know assessments perhaps and post-secondary success would that would that stakeholder input would that be somehow incorporated in the the portal or do you envision i think i think when we reference it here we were focusing specifically on the creation of the new accountability system um and and and what

[07:21:41] what the uh what the bifurcation of the current system looks like as we develop a new accountability system and develop a compliance-based accreditation system. I think that's our focus, is

hearing from families and from parents and from students and from educators and stakeholders on what that accountability system should look like. But, I mean, we can certainly explore opportunities to hear, especially from parents, on what the development of those parent dashboards and what those parent systems need to look like. We can certainly prioritize that.

[07:22:14] curious okay thank you so anybody else we'll go slide two for a moment slide three rather slide three i just want to give y'all been working so hard on this i i just want to give you a chance that slide three one more of the green circles there we go there you go kudos i think this is what we asked for and and and i'm super excited to see it um i think the other another one of the confounding variables here is that accreditation always has connotation i think separate this is good so while this is i'm excited about this you've had a chance to really wrap your minds around it

[07:22:53] why would why should we not like this what are some what are what could be some unintended consequences of this bifurcation nice can i start that response mr president of course okay this is super high level but as we've been having just some initial conversations with folks outside of education um first of all communication is key and that's going to be in stakeholder uh stakeholder groups with lots of folks across the commonwealth. But the concept of just separating accreditation

[07:23:28] from accountability, you talked about assessments being sort of ingrained, and they've been around a long time. They're institutionalized. So is the term accreditation. In most states, accreditation refers to exactly what's up here, and accountability refers to what's on this slide. But in Virginia, and for a really long time, accountability and accreditation have been conflated. And I don't mean that in a negative way. They've just been combined. And so really helping folks understand that there are important, really important compliance measures, teacher-student ratios.

[07:24:06] That's really important. But that is a compliance. That's checking a box. That's an assurance to the state. It is not one of the qualitative or more controllable aspects that can be supported within a high-quality education system that need to be measured in an accountability system.

[07:24:27] So that's even complicated for those of us on the dais to understand, and I get that. Imagine now taking that show on the road and really trying to up the game of all Virginians as we try to explain this. So again, 100,000 foot view is this is going to take and require really high quality, ongoing and diverse communication with lots and lots of stakeholders along the way. Have y'all seen anything ugly coming out from under the rug as you've thought about this? Other than that the timeline is aggressive, it takes every branch of the department

[07:25:05] and every office. So any reasons not to do it. I agree. When we've done what we've done for so long, the communication of changes okay and then my last little thing on that is i guess my only other concern actually i think it's really connected communications um phase one phase two could feel in the field like you're telling me in advance you're going to change the goal posts so we have to make sure that that whatever phase one and phase two are it's almost it is truly foundation

[07:25:42] and then you know furniture in the house kind of stuff so i just i just want to be careful that it doesn't feel like oh we're doing this this year and then next year it's harder uh that's that's going to be just a consideration i think it's going to be for us so i think ellen and one of the things that this gives me some comfort is that i think i heard kim say that this will be coupled with resources i mean we can continue to redo accountability systems you know every couple years and unless you change what you do based upon what you find there's no point right

[07:26:18] and so i mean i am hopeful that we really mean it and i don't mean you kim i mean we the government in this case really mean it in a way frankly differently than back in 95 or so when they did the you know sol based solely accountability system and the theory was resources would follow you know places that need it and it really just politically didn't happen there were some inroads with you know but there really was not a serious effort so uh you know i'm supportive of the idea of looking at this but to do it without then making the commitment the legitimate administration

[07:26:57] commitment to fund you know what what it is we find i mean frankly you know you raise the cut scores to the equivalent of nate proficient what you're going to find is a significant percentage of our kids now failing or being labeled as failing. And then the second question is, what do you do then in terms of what resources are you going to apply to that in order to, you know, change that situation? And again, resources here, I don't mean money, it's how you use the money that matters. You know, we had a, there was a quick comment made

[07:27:33] before that we don't do the budget, which is actually correct. But, you know, what we do have, and you know we link it a little bit but not enough is the prescribed standards of quality which is our constitutional obligation the soqs you know are in fact a budget mechanism we don't get them funded but it is the board's way of saying this is the way we think you ought to spend the money and i will not be on the board by the time this gets moving but i hope that you all

[07:28:05] consider looking at tying changes to the SOQs to results in whatever accreditation system or accountability system, excuse me, you guys come up with, because then you could, again, you can't fund it, but you can at least signal where the funding ought to be to the General Assembly. And hopefully over time, once you set out the marker, the legislature tends to bend toward that marker over time. So I hope you don't lose that in this, because I mean, without making

[07:28:39] spending changes, you know, we can just kill all the brain cells we want doing this, and it's not going to make a difference on the ground. Well, it's interesting. I appreciated the question that was posed about what, that was why we should be concerned about this, so that we're thinking proactively. And that was an interesting question, because when I first saw this slide, and I saw standards standards of quality associated with compliance and because compliance is about

[07:29:11] checking the box i immediately sort of worried that oh my goodness that's like saying those things are really not consequential student outcomes and it really you know i i took note of that in my mind i didn't sort of stop the presentation but seeing it like that just like is that the right message so to the point you articulated about communication you know that

[07:29:43] box being associated with compliance would further potentially undermine um this board's ability to make the case for these things do have an impact on what happens for students and i would not want to see that misunderstood in an effort to shine a spotlight on how well are students actually doing there is great legitimacy in that but that's what i thought about when i immediately saw that so thank you for asking the question and your response on communication it brought me back to

[07:30:21] something that came to my mind and i didn't want to interrupt the presentation to articulate anybody else yeah i just i don't believe the point i don't love the term compliance but i also like you shouldn't show up not liking something without a better solution which i don't have um but like i do think it's what because we're implying more than that but we're but but it's also not we're not gonna accreditation's you know a serious thing we're not going to be disruptive so i don't know what that is but i

do worry that word could cause confusion they want to think about a different term um but again i'm i apologize i don't know uh i don't know what that term is

[07:30:59] um i'm just curious i have a couple of questions one the legislature my understanding is considering some changes right now that are going to impact us around this is that correct it might depend on what aspects like what what is going on the legislature right now that we should be aware of relative to this i guess is my question i'm not aware of in superintendent bailaway and if i'm wrong about this but i'm not aware of any um bills or okay so there's nothing okay i can't keep track of everything there's that one small bill that changes triennial it's a very minor it doesn't go at the heart of any of this but it gets rid of using the three

[07:31:39] year okay so i gives this a place but okay that's why i i wanted to make sure i was clear on that um uh how fast should we go in your opinion i mean i i mean i like the idea that we can make earlier talking about the different indicators and you know the three buckets and that we could like how fast should we we need to have like a trans we have we have to balance like two things it seems like we have a problem with some degree of urgency we also need some degree of predictability for the schools to operate in an effective way and how do we balance those like how fast how how fast should we go on some of this i like the timeline could we go faster should we go faster

[07:32:17] i guess is my question i think the timeline as it is currently is intended to provide enough notice for school divisions to know what the rules are for the coming year and i think that's why we proposed it as we did so that we were not changing things without providing notice we just wanted to be really mindful i think of kind of changing the rules in the middle of the game absolutely and and just making sure that everybody understood what our expectations were as an agency and as a state and as a board right going into each school year so i mean i think that we certainly we we could

[07:32:57] have drawn this out longer i think we could have shortened it i think we could have accomplished some of these items in a shorter period of time but i think this strikes that kind of middle of the road balance where it's it's a very reasonable time frame that that adequately provides notice to schools okay and i don't want to belabor it now it's late in the afternoon but like this idea of if we do need to use emergency or could use emergency regulations to expedite any of this when you guys come back at the next meeting it would be helpful to understand like any flexibility we might have there too and i agree we do not want to change the rules in the middle of the game i think like changing it this year that's completely untenable but like we can talk about future

[07:33:33] seasons right um uh and and so i just want to be thoughtful on that what are you all thinking about graduation rates that's always been a bit of a sticky wicket as shelly knows what are you all thinking about what we should be doing on graduation rates now that should be i think the idea of coming into compliance with with um federal law generally makes sense it'll create less confusion but um you know and they're we're in compliance with federal item to imply that but using their the using using that as an anchor right so what are we thinking about with graduation raise because yeah we have a we have a whole suite of them

[07:34:12] question of what what would be we're not thinking about or could come back at us or that you know could be a little bit difficult and that's well this is really wonderful because it has one system that's evaluating schools school quality has one system where they're figuring out the supports that the school

needs um this is clear for parents it's clear for school leaders i mean there's just a lot of really wonderful aspects of this but i think there's going to be some growing pains when

[07:34:47] we are combining the accreditation indicators with the essay indicators because the current rules are different the way we treat parent refusals and accreditation is different than they're treated in our essa rates the way that we count english learner scores is different in accreditation than it is in federal accountability transfer students same thing graduation rates is

[07:35:17] another so on the the federal side right now we report standard and advanced diplomas and so applied studies diplomas that many of our special ed students receive are not included in that that rate so when we have the gci on accreditation that's one of the the components of it so there are going to be some growing pains there's going to be some decisions that we're going to have to make in terms of what's valuable to us and to schools in terms of what we're measuring so that

[07:35:56] That is definitely one of the things we have on my radar to make sure that we have a late discussion. I think that's the decision for the board, right? Do we keep having these different graduation rate calculations, three different ones, right? Or do we combine everything and just have one standard calculation rate for the state that applies for all purposes?

[07:36:17] And I think that's up to this board. And it does. Yeah, I mean, it does. The comparison points and so forth, it does confuse the issue quite a bit for parents, which I guess is my last, and this is not a question as much as a comment. I, obviously, we need to think about resources, and I think there's some questions about school finance in this Commonwealth that we should be asking, but I do think we sometimes get the, and reasonable people can disagree about this, the chain of causation, and I think if you look in a lot of the states that are moving, and a lot of states have in the last year or two really done some pretty ambitious work on finance, it's come on the heels of really good accountability systems, it didn't come in advance, it helped build the case, and there's an awful lot of evidence that when parents get this information, their views

[07:36:56] change. So I don't think it's just an abstract exercise. And parents, I mean, we see this on a bunch of things. Parents' views, if they get accurate information about school spending, their views on school spending tend to change pretty dramatically. If they get accurate views on sort of various financial aspects of the system, if they get information on how students are doing, their views can change. And I think that's a, if you believe in sort of, you know, people's agency and empowerment and ability to make good decisions, that's a good thing, give people more information. And so I think that actually, like we talked about, nothing will change. I think if we get this right and we get that communication piece right, it could actually change the conversation in the Commonwealth in some really positive ways, particularly for the

[07:37:35] students who right now we find furthest from opportunity, who have been sort of left somewhat invisible in the way we do it now. I think that it could have an incredibly salutary effect on the conversation about what is actually happening for those kids. And those of you who know me know I always like every day wake up and I'm like why is that not on the front page because that seems like a crisis um but I'm not an editor it's not my that's not my choice um but I think if we had better information on that we would have a we would have a more urgent conversation than than the one than the one we've had which speaking just myself is a conversation I I really would

[07:38:08] like us to have Mr. President yes my my comment just actually flows well after uh I promised the comment? Well, I mean, so I think I absolutely love this, you know, that this I absolutely adore.

[07:38:25] And so thank you all for your work on this. The one thing that I will say that maybe needs to be thought of that's different than what we normally do is instead of sort of that communication being a top down, so for example, from the superintendents flowing down to their teachers and to parents, maybe invest in an opportunity to communicate from the bottom up in some ways because I do think that we need for parents to understand even as deeply as we need for teachers to understand these

[07:38:59] changes as much as we need for our superintendents to understand these changes so I think that communication in a very holistic every stakeholder that's touched by this really needs to know and understand these things so what does it mean for me as a superintendent here's my communication what does it mean for me as a teacher here is the communication what does it mean for me as a parent here's the communication and those are going to be you know similar in some ways but also vastly different in others right because you've got the superintendent that's concerned

[07:39:35] about the financial repercussions of this and just the teacher of how do i make sure i'm doing what i'm supposed to be doing for these particular outcomes on a daily basis and then for those parents again who want to ensure that their children are reaching their greatest potential and also being a part of that school community in a broader way so that's just my two cents here thank you Mr. Gecker thank you all for this presentation I'm having a little trouble understanding what some of the specifics of either phase one or phase two changes are going to be and and some

[07:40:14] of it I understand you don't know yet but one thing I do see is there's talk about cut scores, raising the cut scores to the NAEP proficiency. And on that, I have several questions. And one of them is, and this don't need to be answered today, but when you all come back to us with more concrete proposals, I'd love to hear your understanding of what impact that's going to have on student outcomes. Because I'm sure you have seen the research I have seen, including most recently, Matt Chingo's paper from the Urban Institute that says states that have

[07:40:49] taken steps to dramatically raise their cut scores to align with nape proficiency have had zero impact on student outcomes i mean like it's it doesn't change their nape scores at all so maybe you all seen different research i've seen two or three things that indicate that dramatic changes and cut scores have zero impact on student outcomes now there may be reasons to do it transparency complexity there may be reasons to do it that are other than impacting student outcomes but given that that's our number one goal and that it possibly could have some unintended consequences

[07:41:26] on student outcomes you know we at least need to understand what you understand the research to be tell us what the research is about whether it's going to help student outcomes the second about cut scores is i'd like to understand how you're going to implement that change and when and i think i'm right that that's not part of phase one am i correct on that okay so we have a little more time on this but you know mr roberham has proposed before that um i've heard him say that some folks do you know we have a process for setting cut scores and there are ways to improve upon that

[07:42:00] that we might include business people or higher ed people on those committees that we might supply those committees i've heard other people suggest we might supply those committees different information we might give them different guidance but are we going to throw out that whole committee process i mean because if basically we're going to set our cut scores to align to nape proficient do we really

need all those committees we can save ms ms loving rider a lot of work if we're not asking those committees to look at anything if we're just saying align with so so i'd like

[07:42:34] to hear what the plan is on the process changes and i do think that this board should you know given that we're the ones who have to approve the cut scores at the end we should have input into that process so again when you come back at the appropriate phase uh when we talk about ways to impact student outcomes i understand the literacy act that's good you know when we talk about how drastic how we're worried about our reading our nape reading scores i understand the literacy act is going to impact that in k-3 and the legislature is looking mr rutherham at extending the literacy act approach to upper grades which is phenomenal so that's something that we're going to do that's

[07:43:13] going to make a difference for student outcomes how is any of this going to make a difference to student outcomes is something i'd like to hear more about um the second thing i'd like to hear more about and hopefully we can hear this today given their assertive timeline i don't understand i don't have any concept of what the changes are going to be in phase one what kinds of things are under consideration for the phase one changes i understand what's not in it cut scores but what's

[07:43:44] in the phase one bucket so it's primarily things that the board already has the authority to do and amy mentioned some of them so you have i heard but i didn't hear any what they meant okay so have authority to change the benchmarks so you have indicators with various benchmarks um like this improvement benchmark could be so instead of 75 it has it would be 80 or something or you know the floor to be eligible for improvement could be higher remember on achievement

[07:44:19] it has to be the pass rate has to be at least 50 so that that might be a possible change you can add an indicator you have to create a benchmark but you can add an indicator that's what kind of indicators might we consider adding um potentially you could decide that you want to add one that deals with proficiency rates solely right now we have the combined rate but that might be a possibility well if you had a proficiency solely wouldn't that completely then you would just be the growth rate would go out right because our current indicator measures are you have to pass

[07:44:54] all of them it's not a it's not a system where we average your ratings on the different indicators if you if we put in a proficiency indicator as a separate indicator wouldn't that wipe out the combined rate indicator would be two separate indicators but i mean if you put both of them in there would be zero schools in other words if you don't pass the proficiency in a great indicator then you would by definition not pass the other so i don't understand how that would work to add a proficiency indicator and so when we come back in april i'd like to understand how

[07:45:34] that would impact but overall i think i hear you saying that miss ritchie's saying part of the problem that's trying to be addressed is perception that the current system isn't identifying enough schools as needing more intervention from the state so you're talking about raising numbers such that we would be identifying more school flagging more schools so i i just want to be very clear i i did not say that the that the goal is to identify more schools for improvement right

[07:46:09] okay i think that what our focus on is creating a more transparent system that does focus more on proficiency still includes growth but makes the north star of the system proficiency so make it more rigorous get more transparent that could result in a higher number of schools that are identified as in need of support and to president gecker's point we would be prepared to respond to that but the goal is not

to identify more schools right the goal is not to identify what is referring to is your comment that the current system masks some schools right i'm

[07:46:47] hearing that's what she's referring to yeah that's what i was referring to and i just think that goes more to the transparency issue well so if okay i hear you so but let me let me phrase it this way when we hear from you next in march or april if you are proposing um changes to indicators i would hope one thing you would give us is a prediction based on current data what would be the impact on the number of schools that the office of school quality would be needing to deal with and what would be the impact on their staffing and when are you know what are the research what you know

[07:47:23] jlark has already identified that that office is severely understaffed i don't know whether the governor put in a budget amendment or whether others are putting in the budget amendments for consideration in this session to uh beef up i know in prior years um proposals to beef up the staff of of office of school quality have incrementally changed but overall have not been you know we're we're we're inadequate compared to our peers peer states and uh so if these changes are going to go into effect that quickly where's the money um and how's the money going to catch up with the need

[07:48:01] and that's just the resources at office of school quality not even getting to the resources in the schools so uh tell us you know what are what when you propose changes to the indicators what's that going to do to based on current data what would that look like um and particularly on the on the phase one changes um and when we talk about more weight on proficiency versus growth i hear you on that and i understand that ultimately what we want is all of our kids to get to proficiency and i do

[07:48:36] think that's why under the current uh model we don't consider growth in the upper grades we don't we don't consider growth in high school we just consider proficiency right uh the the growth measures are all the k through eight i mean three through eight um but um if we're gonna put more weight on proficiency and less on growth and especially if we're talking about some ultimately if this is ultimately moving towards some kind of star rating system or um a through f grading

[07:49:09] system rating system my read of the research is that those systems unless they are heavily weighted on growth not proficiency basically just tell you that poor schools that serve poor communities do poorly and so unless so when i hear you say you want to wait proficiency more well you know i can tell you who's going to flunk those tests right now we don't have to give the tests you know i can give you the economic data on virginia and that will tell you the outcome and then i can tell you what will happen when you put those star rating systems on those schools i can tell you what will

[07:49:43] happen is teachers unless there's some significant resources teachers will flow out of those poorly rated schools where they're that they're already flowing out of um so um so i'm really coming back to uh yeah but i feel like we have this conversation i just have to say the sort of demographic destiny talk makes me extremely uncomfortable there are schools that beat the odds we're talking about accountability system with individual kids and there are kids and it makes me extremely uncomfortable to hear us so talking in in very very broad strokes i think certainly if you look at our sol results if we have a more meaningful accountability system the number of

[07:50:23] schools identified is as needing improvement is going to go up i think there's a rich conversation we had about what kind of support because it obviously is incumbent upon us if we do this to then think about what kind of support but i just get very nervous when we start that that this is that this is inevitable i think i think it low balls the educators absolutely there are exceptions and but the law of

averages the research i've seen and you and i can exchange research because i know you're very well first in these topics but the research i've seen unless a star rating type system heavily measures growth then it basically increases racial segregation and in the school

[07:50:59] it increases housing segregation it um it doesn't help the bottom kid we can we can have a longer conversation the one point to leave it on a point of agreement i do think with the cut score i i don't want to prejudge the process and committees i do think it would behoove us to have a chingos could be great tom loveless has done a lot of work on this we could have mark schneider back i think there's there's probably a lot of expertise we're going to want to have as we think about what what does setting it at that level actually mean in which we consider and i would hope that during our work sessions we could invite some folks uh to come to richmond and then i'll just circle back to where we began is which i really do think getting good growth measures and i think that

[07:51:38] dr siebert understands this so much better than i ever will how can we i mean i do what i've heard schools say you know you can have growth measures embedded in the the work that students are doing on their laptops every day and you know ed tech has come up with 21st century solutions to this that we aren't we aren't at yet and i do think having good growth measures one thing this administration with your secretary's expertise one of the lasting contributions to virginia's education system could be to improve our growth measures and this rfp is an opportunity to do that

[07:52:17] okay we are going to cut this one here because we have one more to go that we have to do i'm sorry i thought this was the last i do too i apologize as well it's okay it's okay i thought we'd move the other one yeah thank you all very much thank you so much sure

[07:52:43] 645 is looking more like we're going to wait just an assistant superintendent of teacher ed in

[07:55:37] licensure and i've asked my colleague our director of licensure and school leadership maggie clemens to join me for the presentation today um i know the hour is late um and so so our presentation really can be quite brief but we really wanted to provide an opportunity to have dialogue to answer any questions and just to be available to the board as you prepare for tomorrow's first review of the Arlington County Public Schools alternate route to licensure pursuant to House Bill 2486. So again our presentation can be very short and really is

[07:56:15] the intent is to provide you an opportunity and so again high level we are going to be using the powerpoint hopefully kevin will help us with advancing the slides not yet as well as two additional documents that we shared with the board in advance providing an overview and background and context to support the board item for tomorrow the first slide our attempt here is to provide really a very succinct description of the components of licensure as we prepare teachers

[07:56:52] in the commonwealth regardless of the path or the route that we're going to be sharing with you these are the key components you see here that all endorsements must include and must address so any individual attempting to pursue credentials in a commonwealth must have a bachelor's degree from a nationally recognized college or university you see there the exception of technical professional licenses and that's in some of our cte areas the content or the subject matter professional studies for example our class management the curriculum development child

[07:57:29] of development assessment etc and notice typically you see there we either embedded clinical experiences or separate clinical experiences that support those professional studies courses, and the

board approved prescribed assessments and then related statutory requirements.

[07:57:48] Next slide. I'm sorry, is national recognized by the United States Department of Education. Okay. That's the criteria. Okay. And so the next slide, I think you skipped ahead, go back a little bit.

[07:58:04] In terms of the routes to licensure, the routes, again, some may describe it as pathways. And so as we are presenting in the following slides, you'll note that we're highlighting three main routes or pathways in the Commonwealth.

[07:58:23] You'll see here the approved or traditional program route and the adjoining regulations for approved programs highlighted there. Reciprocity, you see the specific code reference there, and then alternate routes, which will be the focus of the remaining slides.

[07:58:40] the first route we're just quickly highlighting for your comparison is the approved program regulation and you see here the regulations and the next slide kevin highlight pretty much again the minimum that the universities in the commonwealth the 36 universities in the commonwealth must address at minimum they provide content in alignment with our regulations regarding the endorsement as well as embedded in a degree program and so in addition to our licensure state course requirements they are also meeting sacks or various accreditation requirements for a degree then you also notice

[07:59:20] typically there's an exit requirement of a gpa major as well as the methods courses fall in that category the professional studies again and clinicals student teaching or a culminating experience the assessments and statutory requirements and then again if you're interested we've also provided you the links there on our new updated website highlighting the list of the 36 programs as well as contacts and the specific endorsements at each institution and i'll pass the baton to maggie to take on the next slide i've been told that i only have 15 minutes and i could talk about licensure all day so i apologize um alternate routes falls under

[07:59:59] our wheelhouse in the office of licensure and school leadership and even though we've got the traditional routes and our licensure specialists process those licenses we also have every other route that comes to us so anything else is really considered these alternate routes reciprocity falls under that approved program because part of reciprocity is when somebody can bring their full comparable license to virginia we can give them a license here they can also complete an approved program out of state um and bring that um that program um approval here to us and we can grant them a license but the alternate routes and this is the the main chunk that we want to focus on

[08:00:38] today the alternate routes are um there are a lot of them um and so a lot of folks uh kevin next slide a lot of folks have heard career switcher this term is kind of used interchangeably to talk about not only our certified career switcher programs uh there are five of them in virginia but also folks who are coming in mid-career they are literally career switching and so it's really important to understand that the certified career switcher program is an actual approved route to licensure in virginia people don't have to go through that route but if they

[08:01:15] want to they have five choices right here we certify those alternate routes another alternate route to licensure is with the provisional license thank you is the provisional license and provisional licenses are issued at the request of an employing school division or a credited private school. And so again, they still have to have all of the components of an approved program. So they still have to have that earned bachelor's degree. They're still going to meet the content requirements, but with the content and

the professional studies, it means with this provisional license that they've met the minimum license requirements in order to get

[08:01:54] that provisional license. So that provisional license will be valid for three years while they satisfy the rest of their requirements, allowing them to teach in the classrooms while satisfying their requirements. Next slide. Another alternate route is just for professional studies. You might be familiar and have heard of Hanover's program recently. Hanover's program was approved under this particular alternate route because they are targeting provisionally licensed teachers.

[08:02:23] These teachers have already satisfied the minimum licensure requirements, and so they're typically lacking those 18 hours of professional studies and assessments. And so they are, the program in Hanover was specifically approved for professional studies.

[08:02:39] So the division can offer those provisional professional studies, either themselves or, you know, partnering with a community college or that type of thing so that they can offer those provisionally licensed teachers the professional studies so that they can satisfy their requirements. Next slide.

[08:02:55] Next slide. We also have a lot of folks who come into our special education classrooms on provisional license, and most of our folks do that because the requirements to have a special education license, a full special education license, There are a lot of courses that go along with that.

[08:03:12] So we allow for folks to take that prerequisite course that focuses on legal aspects and characteristics of special education, get that provisional license at the request of the employing school division, and then they can go into the classroom and work on their deficiencies while they're in the classroom towards that full renewable license and special education.

[08:03:33] Next slide. And then the last, or the other one under the regs, I should say, is the experiential learning and so these are this route is actually um similar to if you're employed it's very similar to just getting the provisional license you satisfy the content requirement with your praxis test and then you feel you can finish your professional studies and we use your three years of documented successful work experience to get you a full renewable license if you're not employed that's how that works if you're employed then it's just a provisional license and you have

[08:04:09] those those three years to to get that and then the last one um is really the focus of your board item tomorrow um and this is um an alternate route under the code the ones that i just shared previously are under the regulations um this one is under the code under and if we um it came under hb 2486 during the 2019 um session you guys recently sent it um and had a update to the technical update to the guidelines last fall, but this allows for a school division to partner with

[08:04:45] another educational organization and not just provide the professional studies, but they can provide the content, the professional studies, alternate assessments, like this is kind of a whole golden ticket package, very similar to what a traditional program at a four-year university could offer, but this is the school division partnering with somebody who can offer that for their people in their division what happens at the end of this is a full renewable license with an endorsement in virginia that they can use all over the state but the route itself is for that

[08:05:21] particular division um and so this is really for those divisions that have a local need um and so folks who you know obviously we've got lots of different routes um but these are this is this this route was

made for localities that had a specific need to target teachers to get the whole package for them so that they can move forward into a classroom.

[08:05:44] - And we hope that that was a high level overview. - I did it in five minutes. - You did awesome. - So again, we are available for questions. And again, given time, we would welcome emails if you wanted to as well share with us.

[08:06:01] That way we'll be glad to respond. We also, a question maybe well you know dr johnson and um dr clemens i think that it it's just important to kind of front load this with why we asked you to present this tonight and um and front load a little bit about give us a preview of what's coming in front of us tomorrow and um i just i really appreciate the information and of course our goal and we've had lots and lots of discussions about this but our goal is to make sure that we have lots of ways to get high quality teachers in the classroom to first of all make sure we have high quality teachers with our kids second of all to

[08:06:41] make sure that we solve some of the issues with the the teacher shortages and um and at the same time we want to control for quality and make sure that anyone who's in the classroom as we're growing this number and growing the pathways is a high quality teacher and has the desire and the ability and the support to continue to grow professionally into master teachers so that's that's the high level entry but i would love for you all to just give a bit of a preview as to why i asked you to slow down and um and just give us this preview or give us this information today yes certainly so

[08:07:20] the um first couple of alternate routes that i've mentioned are all under the regulations and have all been in place for several years, if not decades. And so this is the alternate path that most teachers are going through. But the catch is for most of these, they are employed and they've met content and they are doing it in a different way, but they're still meeting those approved program guidelines and regulations. But the one that's coming before you tomorrow, this is a proposal from Arlington County, and they want to blend the Montessori nationally credentialed

[08:07:58] license, the national license for Montessori, with the Virginia competencies so that their teachers in their Montessori classrooms, because they do have seven Montessori schools in Arlington, they want those teachers to benefit from having a Virginia license and us recognize their montessori license and so it's kind of a blend of what we do and what they do and it recognizes the work that they've done already so that they're not having duplicate efforts and going back to a university and starting a whole new program over again or doing the professional

[08:08:33] studies all over again or any of the content over again um the original a proposal for um from arlington um really was more of a um you know we'll ask and you probably saw the proposal versus the panel's recommendation the proposal was um indicated assessments obviously the bachelor's degree assessments but then basically using that montessori as a one-to-one the panel reviewed it and the panel recommended additional coursework for that because HB 2486 doesn't authorize the

[08:09:12] agency or this panel to create another license, restrict, or do anything to our current license and endorsements. What it allowed was for a different pathway to reach the same end goal, and so the panel reviewed what they had proposed and didn't feel as if the Montessori curriculum and the assessments completely addressed all of the Virginia competencies and the approved program regulations. And so they have recommended that there's additional coursework. And that additional coursework are three methods classes and then a reading and language arts class,

[08:09:49] which aligns with the Virginia Literacy Act that we knew that was coming on board the next couple of years. So we wanted to address that instruction as well. So the panel had done that. So if you look at the proposal versus what the panel had suggested there is a little bit of a difference there um and so i think what you'll hear tomorrow is that the montessori um folks really would like to see um you know more of a one-to-one with that assessment um versus what the panel had recommended but again at the end of the day the panel reviewed the proposal based on 2486 which

[08:10:24] didn't allow for us to create anything new it just gave us a process for approving a different route with the same end goal how many and i don't know what we're up to how many applications so we're talking about montessori tomorrow but in in a in a bigger picture we're talking about the process yeah or uh you know we this board has a has a directive to a a legislative directive to um make this route available so tomorrow it's montessori how many other applications do we

[08:10:58] have in the pipeline to um to be reviewed not not montessori not necessarily montessori um we're really excited actually we have 15 divisions who have separately um already put in applications it is one educational partner that all of them are using but because of the language of 2486 each individual division has to submit their own application which makes sense because each individual division is going to put their own voice on how those teachers are going to be trained in partnership and evaluated with the with this educational partner so we've got 15

[08:11:35] that are using this one educational partner and then we've got three or four um that have not submitted their application yet but i know that they will that are partnering with community colleges so nova has already reached out to two that i'm expecting to have applications from very soon and then um walk here has got um i can't remember the name of the community college because they just changed names but um there it's another community college that they want to partner with so thank you superintendent for mentioning that because we are acknowledging we are making precedent this is the first time that this bill will be implemented in this particular route used

[08:12:11] And so it's a unique presentation, and your decision will confirm the precedent. Who is the partner that everybody seems to want? I teach. Okay.

[08:12:27] It is a for-profit. They're based in Texas. They are CAPE accredited, and they've been working in Virginia with these school divisions for trying to get MOUs in place and get these applications done since last fall.

[08:12:42] So separating what we're going to hear tomorrow is separate. Right. Right. And then what is the portability with these licenses after they're issued? Like. So under 2486, that's that was the entire point. Right. So it's an alternate route.

[08:12:58] But the end goal is still to get a Virginia license with a endorsement. They could take that to a different division after their three years and they've earned it. They could take it to a different state if they needed to. But it would not carry any restrictions because the idea is the alternate route still satisfies all of the components of the approved program.

[08:13:18] Similar to the experiential learning gaps or things that need to be done, or is that an easier process? This particular one is interesting because elementary and SPED are one of our few endorsements where you can't just take a test to meet that minimum threshold for licensure.

[08:13:40] It's the test, then there's coursework, and then there's methods, classes on top of some of that, and then there's the professional studies. So Arlington's is unique in that it's the elementary ones and the middle school that they're looking at. This means those entities are granting the license?

[08:13:59] They become? No. Okay, it's still being board of education. Yes, absolutely, absolutely. They would still, at the end of the day, have to have our specialists review the information that the division has submitted on their behalf that verifies that they've completed all of the components of their proposal.

[08:14:21] Is Arlington tomorrow asking us to approve something other than, less than, what the panel is recommending to us? So, in other words, you said the panel upped the ante a little bit. Is Arlington going to ask us to lower that ante, or are they just asking us to approve it, even if it's not their preference?

[08:14:43] So I think that there's been some misunderstanding with 2486. We've said this with all of our proposals. The end goal is going to be a Virginia license with an endorsement that we currently hold. We don't have the authority to change the license types or restrict anything.

[08:14:59] That is your authority, and it would have to go through the regulatory process. So we've been very clear up front, and when we went through the panel presentation, our panel review, you know, the panel asked for additional information, wanted to make sure it did the crosswalk with the competencies, and that was what the recommendation of the panel was to add these additional courses on there.

[08:15:18] When the board, when the item posted, I guess that was the impetus for the communication with our office, they indicated that they thought that it was going to be a straight, their proposal was going to be done at face value.

[08:15:34] And so I think that they might have been surprised and it's been indicated that they will likely use public comment tomorrow to share that they would like to have it at their proposal, not at the panel's recommendation. And is that something you think we have authority to grant not based on this and, and correct me if I'm wrong. I, I, I kind of put Jim's name in an email earlier as our regulatory and legal coordinator. Um, I do believe that any changes to licenses, um, and endorsements is something that would have to go through the regulatory process, starting with Abtel. And then you would have to, and then you guys would have the whole.

[08:16:13] your your advice to us is what they're asking us to do we can't do i don't know if you can do it tomorrow you i think that you absolutely can that's within your authority i just don't think that you can do it without going through a full regulatory process and again as a reminder we have the state superintendent's recommendation in the item but the board still has the flexibility to say no, to say yes, to modify. But we don't have the flexibility to say yes to what they're going to ask us for at least that's not tomorrow. This is one of those unfortunate times when it's

[08:16:50] it's kind of on it's first review tomorrow. Oh good. Yeah, because here's a here's something I'd like to we don't we can't do this for tomorrow but when we have a division it's here on something particular you know I think we would it be unprecedented or would it be possible to have them be able to be at the table in case we have discussion questions that they can help address when the item comes up rather than just the two minutes in public comment is that a bad precedent i don't think so i think it's a good thing you think it's a good thing yeah so it may not work for tomorrow i mean maybe it would but if given that this is just first review we could certainly

[08:17:29] do it in at the next meeting second the final review we've given other school divisions who who have come before us in the past, the opportunity to be basically up, right? We've invited, like when Rita Bishop was here years ago, we just had her up. - So, 'cause I mean, I would like to ask them, our council tells us we don't have authority to grant you today, which the full Monty, we can give you something close.

[08:17:54] - The full Monty, sorry. - The full Monty, good. - That was getting a little punchy. - The closest we can come is approving what the panel is recommending, you know, that's not good enough for you then we'd have to go through a much longer regular sort of process we can share that advice that's what we're hearing and have them tell us if they think that's wrong i mean you've got longer term questions too right about quality control i mean you're effectively granting uh educational prep capability to a school division which for harlington might be okay but then if you've already got the for profits involved you wonder at what point you know when

[08:18:33] When does it become essentially a money-making business for the divisions? You know, we've proved that virtual joint school in Southwest, basically money, as opposed to ensuring quality. Do we want to, is it possible to decide now to let them know, you know, people are planning to come down for four hours of public comment in the morning, that maybe we'll get to, maybe we'll give them an opportunity to speak in the afternoon?

[08:18:57] Well, I would certainly, you know, if Francisco came down as an example, he could certainly speak. I think if he's got 25 teachers lined up to come talk, that's not going to be at the table, right? - Right, right, gotcha. - I think it's the Montessori. - Okay, well, I meant, you know, just 'cause we know Francisco, but essentially.

[08:19:17] - But you're also making the distinction, if they're gonna come in mass, come in the public comment section. - Yeah, no, if the leadership comes, I'm happy to have them speak, you know, but-- - During the item, right. - During the item, but if it's, like I said, 25 supporters, that's not really appropriate for the item presentation itself.

[08:19:33] Can I make one other point, because I just want to make sure that I'm really clear. It's not that they aren't asking us to give them a license in Virginia with the endorsement. They want us to remove the recommendation of those extra four classes, and they think that their program, just the Montessori and the Praxis, enables them to be eligible for our full license.

[08:19:57] And so what they're asking you, what I assume that they're going to ask is that the recommendation is just the board is going to approve their proposal where the praxis, the bachelor's degree, and the Montessori credential is enough for the Virginia license. I don't know as they're going to ask, will you restrict a license or will you create a new one?

[08:20:17] But in conversations that we had in the panel, and I'm sure that you guys are also questioning, you know, that would likely come up. so i just wanted to bring up that it's not that they they specifically have asked us to restrict or um create a new license it's just that this particular route was reviewed under 2486 which doesn't allow us to do that can i have a question really quickly so the school division is fully on board with this and and i mean it is not abnormal in other states for them to do just what the montessori people are expecting because there are a lot of states that take that there are 10 states

[08:20:55] that take that uh two of them are there are only two of those 10 that have that take it one for one with no restrictions and don't require any kind of testing like we require praxis or they take it basically

a one for one here's your montessori here's your state license but this will require them under any circumstances to be in compliance with praxis requirements correct for us here they will have their proposal originally said that their folks would pass the praxis test but again with the um with the elementary ed uh endorsement you can't get the

[08:21:32] endorsement with just praxis you have to have the praxis with those additional courses yes ma'am right and if i understand correctly what the panel is recommending is that we give them provisional licenses yes absolutely based on the criteria their the montessori folks are promoting yes and then that we give that gives them the three years to get there absolutely every other the montessori is more of their of their golden ticket to get them the provisional license but then they've got these three years to to finish like every other route like every other route two quick questions um the slide number five virginia approved programs there are two links

[08:22:10] could these be made clickable please i think they're meant to be there are two hyperlinks on the slide five virginia approved programs i think those two links are made to be clickable but they're not um they should be and that might be because of the um recent migration on the website so i'll go back and double check that yes ma'am okay second thing is so this is for teachers to teach a montessori program the coursework of which is different from a like a regular classroom right non-montessori classroom they my understanding is that um arlington has these seven

[08:22:48] schools they just teach in the montessori methodology they're still teaching virginia content they're just doing it in a different way and that the children still take as well yes ma'am okay i just want to ask one question before we wrap up um just clarifying especially in your questions when you asked about procedurally could you actually do what they want so i think initially your question and your thought was that they were requesting a different type of license or something that was not part of the regular provisional license what i understood

[08:23:24] is asking that these teachers being licensed without having to take this extra course correct but but so we came to that after some discussion and so to answer that question you could make that decision because that's that was the recommendation of the panel to have additional course requirements to align with the the approved program regulations but the board could do that allow them whole licenses without those extra courses yes you can do that you could you couldn't create a new license or restrict their license to just montessori the next one that'll come in it's another division

[08:24:05] I wanted to ask the question and thank those that you ask. It is an important nuance. And just, you know, we have other things that we need to do tonight. But just for example, you know, I asked the question, not particular to Montessori, but especially in elementary, how are we going to assure that they have, for example, the science of reading base that they need to be able to implement the Virginia Literacy Act, like we should not have to only rely on external training once they're hired to be able to deliver science of reading instruction effectively

[08:24:42] and so um you know those are those are assurances method methods classes um in elementary uh other specific courses or um opportunities that that we want teachers to have i mean those are all things that that we've been thinking about that we've been talking about and that's going to make this a really unique process because again that I you know the the premise is that there are lots of ways to get great teachers in the classroom how do we assure that with alternate alternative pathways to our choices our choice our

[08:25:17] choices tomorrow are to deny the request our choice tomorrow is to hear it next month we are adjourned see you at nine in the morning

